Safety Procedures and Practices

Rev. 15

Aviation Academy

RECORD OF REVISIONS

REVISION #	ISSUE DATE	NAME	ACTION
Original	11/18/2019	David Cruz	
1	05/01/2020	Christopher Ramey	Removed all references to the Grayson Country Airport (GYI) Campus; Modified a note on pg. 7; Added a procedural step to pg. 11; Added steps to determine and record and elevated squawk pg. 22
2	08/19/2020	Christopher Ramey	Adjusted table of contents pg.5; Added Maintenance and squawking procedure at a planned airport pg. 18. Added 2 new definitions pg. 37
3	01/01/2021	Christopher Ramey	Adjusted verbiage and added in statement of where to find electronic version of this document pg. 3; Adjusted table of contents pg. 5; Added in PA44 to table pg. 9; Added in KPOU practice area picture and description pg. 37
4	05/07/2021	Rick Sanchez	Revised Introduction pg. 3; Replaced the term “Student Pilot” with “Pre-Private Pilot” and “PPL” with “PVT” pg. 8; Replaced the term “gust factor” with “gust spread” and removed a redundant wind table on pg.9; Max Crosswind Component on PA34 changed to 12 knots on pg. 9; Added Pre-Private Expanded Wind Limitations on pg.10; Revised Fire Extinguisher usage pg. 16; Added KPOU Phone Number pg. 17; Added KPOU Phone Number and Email pg. 20; Discrepancy/Squawk Procedure revised pg. 20 and 23; Added small changes to Elevated Squawk requirements pg. 24; Red Tag procedure revised pg. 25; Added KPOU Practice Area pg. 38; Added Practice Area Reporting Points pg. 38; Added 2 new definitions pg. 41
5	07/23/2021	Rick Sanchez	Slight wording changes for clarification pg.7; Wording changes for clarification, the deletion of the word “training” and the specific words to prohibit any further takeoffs once winds exceed limitation pg. 9; Deletion of the word “training” pg. 11; Addition of the guidance set forth in AC 91-92 for weather planning pg. 12; Addition of KCGI phone number pg. 17; Addition of KCGI phone number and email address pg. 20; Addition of note specifying cross country fuel requirements when departing other than from the origination airport pg. 28; Reworded minimum altitude limitations pg. 30; Revision of KPOU reporting points depiction pg. 40; Addition of KCGI practice areas and frequency pg. 42; Addition of KCGI reporting points pg. 43
6	02/22/2022	Christopher Ramey	Clarified No Fly mins pg. 7; Changed dual traffic pattern weather requirements pg. 7; Changed IFR takeoff mins pg. 7; Made corresponding weather min changes to quick ref guide pg. 8
7	04/01/2022	Christopher Ramey	Removed elevated squawk procedure requirement for Pilot and Dispatch pg. 23 and 24; Clarified return to service for Dispatch pg. 25
8	04/30/2023	Christopher Ramey	Added in KERV Practice Area picture and description pg. 44 and 45
9	12/01/2024	Christopher Ramey	Added in KFFC Practice Area picture and description pg. 46 and 47
10	3/01/2025	Christopher Ramey	Revised all sections to align with the SOP / FOM Appendix Revision 2 changes and updates for March 2025; Removed KDTO U.S. Aviation Academy Unicom contact procedures
11	5/23/2025	Andrew Blevins	Added/updated IFR weather criteria requirements and NO FLY minimums; Added KHYI Practice Area and description

12	08/21/2025	Christopher Ramey	Added KBAZ Practice Area and description; Fixed formatting throughout.
13	10/06/2025	Christopher Ramey	Added KIXD Practice Areas and descriptions; Added Hot Spots to KBAZ Practice Areas
14	05/06/2026	Christopher Ramey	Added KFPR Practice Areas and Descriptions
15	07/08/2026	Dennis Standish	Revised entire Weather Minimums for Solo and Dual Flights

INTRODUCTION

US Aviation Academy (USAA) Safety Procedures and Practices are designed to ensure regulatory compliance per 14 CFR §141.93(a)(3) as well as provide critical information about safety policies, procedures, and practices applicable to all pilots and staff at USAA in the conduct of flight operations.

While it is our obligation to furnish this material and provide training to each student/cadet on its contents, it is the pilots' responsibility to know and abide by this required information. Regular review and referencing of USAA Safety Procedures and Practices is strongly encouraged to ensure you are operating and training within USAA Safety Procedures and Practices at all times.

USAA Safety Procedures and Practices are electronically furnished to every student/cadet enrolled in a flight training course at the time of enrollment. Upon receipt of this material, every student/cadet shall read and study the subject matter. Initial review of this information should be conducted upon acceptance of enrollment of any USAA course. Additional training and application of USAA Safety Procedures and Practices will occur throughout flight training at USAA.

Occasional updates to this material will occur as necessary. The most current version/revision will always be available in the documents section on our website. If you have any questions, concerns or comments about the information found within, please bring it to the attention of your Instructor, Chief/Assistant Chief Instructor, Program Manager, Director, or other Academy Officer.

As a good operating procedure, all pilots on all flights should carry the USAA Safety Procedures and Practices. Electronic versions of this document are available through the USAA Documents sections on both the US Aviation website and the Academy subscription to Foreflight.

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Table of Contents

WEATHER MINIMUMS FOR SOLO AND DUAL FLIGHTS

CEILING, VISIBILITY, AND WIND LIMITATIONS

> **NOTE**:
> *The below minimums apply to all flights except King Air.*
> *See special section below for King Air minimums.*

> **NOTE**:
> *Official weather shall be used for flights.* ***1)*** *The more restrictive weather observation report shall be used to determine weather minimums and go / no-go decisions.* ***2)*** *All Ceilings refer to AGL and winds are reported in true direction.*

NO FLY Weather Minimums:

- Any one of the following conditions will always result in a "No Fly" situation for any non-airborne aircraft:
  - Ceiling below 400' (AGL)
  - Visibility below 2 statute miles
  - Winds reported above 35kts
  - Gust Spread reported above 18kts
  - Crosswinds greater than the Demonstrated Crosswind Velocity or Recommended Pilot Capability as detailed in the aircraft AFM/POH/IM/OM
  - Lightning strikes within a 5-mile radius of the field within 15 minutes

WIND LIMITATIONS (EXPANDED)

General Wind Limitations:

- All flights shall be discontinued when wind conditions exceed the limitations listed below.
- No pilot shall take off again after a landing in which the listed wind limitations were or will be exceeded. Upon the first indication that wind conditions exceed published restrictions, a full-stop landing is required.

Solo Wind Limitations:

- Pre-Private Student (Student Pilot)
  - All pre-private flights shall be discontinued at wind velocities greater than 15 knots (including gusts) or a gust spread of more than 7 knots.
  - Maximum crosswind component shall not exceed 8 knots for pre-private students.

> **NOTE**:
> *All Pre-Private student pilots must have appropriate wind restrictions entered in their logbooks.*
>
> *The maximum entry for wind restrictions cannot exceed USAA Wind Restrictions.*

- Private Pilot or Higher Solo Flight (Student)
  - All Private Pilot or Higher student solo flights shall be discontinued if total wind velocities are greater than 25 knots (including gusts) or gust spreads of more than 15 knots.
  - Maximum crosswind component shall not exceed 15 knots.
    - However, no pilot shall exceed the manufacturer's maximum demonstrated crosswind component per the AFM, POH, or IM/OM.

Instructor / Dual Wind Limitations:

- Flights shall be discontinued if total wind velocities are greater than 35 knots (including gusts) or gust spreads of more than 18 knots.
  - Maximum crosswind component shall not exceed the manufacturer's maximum demonstrated crosswind component per the AFM, POH, or IM/OM.

QUICK REFERENCE: WIND RESTRICTIONS

MAXIMUM TOTAL WIND	VELOCITY	GUST SPREAD
Solo Pre-Private Pilots	15 knots	7 knots
Solo Private Pilot or Higher	25 knots	15 knots
Instructor / Dual Flights	35 knots	18 knots

MAX CROSSWIND COMPONENTS (not to exceed AFM/POH/IM/OM)	VELOCITY
Solo Pre-Private Pilots	8 knots
Solo Private Pilot or Higher	15 knots
Instructor / Dual Flights	Aircraft Component

MAX DEMONSTRATED CROSSWIND COMPONENT	
C-152	12 knots
C-172	15 knots
PA-28R	17 knots
PA-34	13 knots
PA-44	17 knots
P-Mentor	20 knots
P2006T	17 knots
P2010	17 knots
BE-9L	25 knots

WEATHER LIMITATIONS (EXPANDED):

Solo Flight Limitations:

- Traffic Pattern
  - No student solo flight will be conducted unless the ceiling and visibility are at least a 2000'ceiling and visibility is 5 miles during both daytime and nighttime.
- Local
  - No Student Pilot (pre-private) solo flight will be conducted unless the ceiling and visibility are at least a 2500' ceiling and visibility is 5 miles during daytime and 10 miles during nighttime.
  - No Student (private pilot or higher) solo flight will be conducted unless the ceiling and visibility are at least a 2500' ceiling and visibility is 5 miles during daytime and 7 miles during nighttime.
- Cross-Country
  - Student Pilot (Pre-Private)
    - Solo Cross-Country flights will not be conducted unless the conditions are forecast to be a 3000' ceiling and visibility is 7 miles during daytime and

10 miles during nighttime for at least 1 hour before and 1 hour after the estimated time of arrival at each destination.

- Student (Private Pilot or Higher)
  - Solo Cross-Country flights will not be conducted unless the conditions are forecast to be a 2500' ceiling and visibility is 5 miles during daytime and 7 miles during nighttime for at least 1 hour before and 1 hour after the estimated time of arrival at each destination.
- Instrument Meteorological Conditions (IMC) – All USAA Students:
  - No student solo flight, nor two students conducting a PIC Crew flight together, may plan for or intentionally enter IMC, even if operating IFR.
    - If an IFR flight plan is filed and opened, it must be done so only when VFR is guaranteed during the entirety of the flight.

Dual Flight Limitations:

- VFR Local
  - Dual local flights are not permitted unless the ceiling and visibility are at least 2500' and 3 miles for non-multiengine aircraft and for multiengine aircraft, ceiling and visibility are at least 4000' and 3 miles
    - For all dual flights in the traffic pattern only, this minimum can be reduced to TPA + 500' and 3 miles visibility.
- VFR Cross-country
  - Dual cross-country flights will not be permitted unless the ceiling and visibility are forecast to be 2500' and 5 miles for at least 1 hour before and 1 hour after the estimated time of arrival at each destination.
- IFR Local and Cross-country
  - IFR flights shall not be conducted unless both the ceilings and visibility at the furthest planned and filed destination, or any filed alternate airport, or departure airport if filed as such (i.e. round robin) are forecasted to be at least 200 feet above the lowest usable approach ceiling minima and at least 1/2 statute miles above the lowest usable approach visibility at the estimated time of arrival and up to 1 hour afterwards. Note: 14 CFR 91.169 IFR required information and alternate airport weather minima requirements must be verified and will always be utilized when filing an IFR flight plan and when determining an IFR alternate airport.
  - Notwithstanding 14 CFR 91.169 requirements, a flight may depart in IFR conditions when the most recent weather report, for at least one of the destinations or alternates filed in the IFR flight plan, includes a forecast from a planned ETA and up to 1 hour afterwards. This forecast should allow the planned flight to proceed past a final approach fix with ceilings no less than 200 feet above and ½ SM above the lowest usable approach minima.
  - Instrument Approach Weather Minimums apply

Instrument Approach Weather Minimums:

- Proceeding past the Final Approach Fix (FAF) is prohibited unless the existing weather is at least 200 feet and ½ SM above the usable approach minimums for the runway.
  - The term "usable" includes, but is not limited to, situations such as Circle-to-Land Approach minimums, when the Glide Slope is inoperative for an ILS approach, etc., the ceiling and visibility will be applied to the LOC only minimums.
- At no time shall any IFR flight depart an airport when the most recent visibility is reported to be less than 2 statute miles and/or the ceiling is less than 400 feet at the departure airport.

Quick Reference Weather Minimums

DUAL VFR WEATHER	CEILING	VISIBILITY	
Traffic Pattern	TPA + 500'	3 miles	
Practice Area (SE)	2500'	3 miles	Note 1
Practice Area (ME)	4000'	3 miles	Note 2
Cross Country	2500'	5 miles	+/- 1 hour ETA

DUAL IFR WEATHER	CEILING	VISIBILITY	
Local & Cross Country	400'	2 miles	+ 1 hour ETA

SOLO VFR WEATHER	CEILING	VISIBILITY	
Traffic Pattern	2000'	5 miles (day)	5 miles (night)
Local (Student Pilot)	2500'	5 miles (day)	10 miles (night)
Local (Student)	2500'	5 miles (day)	7 miles (night)
Cross Country (Student Pilot)	3000'	7 miles (day)	10 miles (night)
		+/- 1 hour ETA	+/- 1 hour ETA
Cross Country (PVT or Higher)	2500'	5 miles	7 miles (night)
		+/- 1 hour ETA	+/- 1 hour ETA

KING AIR MINIMUMS	CEILING	VISIBILITY	
Precision Approach	400'	2 miles	+ 1 hour ETA
Non-Precision Approach	800'	2 miles	+ 1 hour ETA

Note 1: For single-engine, when required lesson maneuvers consist only of tasks that have a Hard Deck of less than 2,000 feet AGL (i.e., ground reference maneuvers), the flight may be dispatched with ceilings at 2000' AGL.

NOTE 2: FOR MULTIENGINE, WHEN REQUIRED LESSON MANEUVERS CONSIST ONLY OF TASKS THAT HAVE A HARD DECK OF LESS THAN 3,000 FEET AGL (I.E., GROUND REFERENCE MANEUVERS, **SIMULATED** ENGINE OUT PROCEDURES, ETC.), THE FLIGHT MAY BE DISPATCHED WITH CEILINGS AT 3000' AGL.

AIRMET AND SIGMETS

AIRMETS:

- A concise description of the occurrence or expected occurrence of specified enroute weather phenomena that may affect the safety of aircraft operations, but at intensities lower than those which require the issuance of a SIGMET.
- They are informational and cover a wide area
- AIRMETS alone are not restrictive nor a no-go decision-making product; however, all AIRMETS must be reviewed in full detail for occurring weather that could impact the flight.
    - No-go decisions should be based on:
        - Receipt of an official weather briefing
        - The full content and applicability of the AIRMET
    - Any no-go decision for an AIRMET that does not contain weather affecting the flight may be made only after consulting with management (e.g., Team Lead, Assistant Chief, etc.).
        - The Flight Analysis Tool (FAT) form should be marked "*yes*" on External Factors: "*Do you feel pressured to complete this mission today?*"

SIGMETS:

- A concise description of the occurrence or expected occurrence of specified enroute weather phenomena that are expected to affect the safety of aircraft operations
- SIGMETS alone are not restrictive nor a no-go decision-making product; however, any SIGMET ***requires*** an in-depth review to understand the impact of the weather report prior to making a go/no-go decision
    - No-go decisions should be based on:
        - Receipt of an official weather briefing
        - The full content and applicability of the SIGMET
    - Any no-go decision for a SIGMET that does not contain weather affecting the flight may be made only after consulting with management (e.g., Team Lead, Assistant Chief, etc.).
        - The Flight Analysis Tool (FAT) form should be marked "*yes*" on External Factors: "*Do you feel pressured to complete this mission today?*"

OTHER WEATHER RESTRICTIONS

Temperature Limitations:

- While no specific temperature limitations exist for flights (solo or dual), the PIC should consider the aircraft performance charts and any additional weather phenomena as part of the preflight decision-making process.

Thunderstorms:

- Flight in the vicinity of thunderstorms must be fully understood by the PIC prior to operating the aircraft. The PIC is solely responsible for the safety of flight. In general, the guidelines below apply at US Aviation Academy:

1. Determine whether the type of thunderstorm is a steady-state or airmass thunderstorm.
2. Apply the following as applicable to the type of thunderstorm:
    - For Steady-State Thunderstorms, NO flight shall occur when:
        - Anytime safety of flight is a concern
        - Within 25nm of the storm front
        - Within 15nm laterally of the storm front
        - Within 5nm behind the storm front
    - For Airmass Thunderstorms, NO flight shall occur when:
        - Anytime safety of flight is a concern

Flight in Icing Conditions:

- Icing Conditions exist when visible moisture is present, and the outside air temperature (OAT) is at or below 5°C on the ground. This includes, but is not limited to, rain, sleet, snow mixed with liquid water, and fog. Known or forecast icing conditions can be determined with weather reports such as Current Icing Products (CIP), Forecast Icing Products (FIP), SIGMETs, AIRMETs (note 1), METARs, PIREPs, etc., as well as aircraft systems (e.g., OAT indicators). **No flight (solo or dual) will be conducted in known or forecast icing conditions.**
    - Note 1: An AIRMET Z alone does not constitute a complete forecast. Always evaluate all weather conditions before making a go/no-go decision due to forecast icing.
- Icing Conditions include but are not limited to:
    - Freezing Rain (FZRA): Any precipitation that falls as liquid and freezes upon contact with surfaces.
    - Freezing Drizzle (FZDZ): Light precipitation that falls as liquid and freezes upon contact with surfaces.
    - Freezing Fog (FZFG): Fog composed of supercooled water droplets that freeze upon contact with surfaces.
    - Snow (SN): Any form of liquid snow that adheres to the aircraft.
    - Ice Pellets (PL): Small, round pellets of ice that form from the freezing of raindrops or refreezing of largely melted snowflakes.
    - Frost: Formation of ice crystals on the aircraft surfaces due to sublimation.
    - Supercooled Liquid Water: Presence of supercooled droplets in clouds or precipitation that can freeze upon contact with the aircraft.

Frost and Snow on the Aircraft:

- No pilot may take off in an aircraft with frost, ice, or snow adhering to any propeller, wing, windshield, stabilizer, or control surface. Polishing frost is prohibited.

PRE-PRIVATE EXPANDED WIND LIMITATIONS

General:

- The following procedure to expand wind limitations for a pre-private student can only be performed for students enrolled in a private pilot course that requires excessive solo flight time and the student has met the qualifications required by USAA Policy.

Qualifications:

- Minimum Dual Flight Time: 30 hours
- Minimum Solo Flight Time: 11 Hours
- Minimum Progress: Received XC endorsement and completed two XC solos.

Procedure:

1. Review with instructor that qualifications are met.
2. Discuss student and instructor's personal wind limitations.
3. Perform a Dual Flight Evaluation in actual wind conditions with at least 3 touch and goes in a row without any help or input from the instructor.
4. Depending on personal limitations (discussed in #2) and performance (#3), instructor may, at their sole discretion, endorse student for flying in wind conditions beyond the standard for pre-private students. However, the endorsement may never:
    a. Exceed aircraft demonstrated crosswind.
    b. Exceed US Aviation Solo Private Pilot or Higher wind limitations.
    c. Exceed 45 days or the coinciding 90-day solo endorsement, whichever is shorter.
    d. Exceed wind conditions experienced during evaluation in Step 3.
5. USAA's Pre-Private Expanded Wind Limitations Endorsement is placed in student logbook and in the FSP endorsements page.

King Air Minimums

Departure Ceiling & Visibility Minimums:

- Dual Instruction flights shall not be conducted unless both the ceilings and visibility at the furthest planned and filed destination, or any filed alternate airport, or departure airport if filed as such (i.e. round robin) are forecasted to be at least 200 feet above the lowest usable approach ceiling minima and at least 1/2 statute miles above the lowest usable approach visibility at the estimated time of arrival and up to 1 hour afterwards. Note: 14 CFR 91.169 IFR required information and alternate airport weather minima requirements must be verified and will always be utilized when filing an IFR flight plan and when determining an IFR alternate airport.

- Notwithstanding 14 CFR 91.169 requirements, a flight may depart in IFR conditions when the most recent weather report, for at least one of the destinations or alternates filed in the IFR flight plan, includes a forecast from a planned ETA and up to 1 hour afterwards. This forecast should allow the planned flight to proceed past a final approach fix with ceilings no less than 200 feet above and ½ SM above the lowest usable approach minima.

Approach Ceiling & Visibility Minimums:

- Proceeding past the Final Approach Fix (FAF) is prohibited unless the existing weather is at least 200' and ½ SM above the usable approach minimums for the runway.
  - The term usable includes, but is not limited to, situations such as Glide Slope is inoperative for an ILS approach, the ceiling and visibility will be applied to the LOC only minimums.
- If the only approach available would result in a circle to the landing runway, the additive above will be applied to the circling minimums for the approach runway.

Wind Limitations:

- All flights will be discontinued at wind velocities of 35 knots or greater (including gusts) or when gust spreads are more than 15 knots.
- Maximum demonstrated crosswind components shall not exceed 25 knots.

Flight in Icing Conditions:

- Flights into known or probable icing conditions are permitted for this aircraft if properly equipped and functioning equipment is available.
- Flight will not be permitted if the actual or forecast icing conditions are greater than moderate in severity.

WEATHER MINIMUMS COMPLIANCE

As part of the normal preflight preparation for every flight, Pilots shall comply with the following procedure:

1. Pilots will check all available weather reports and forecasts; the obtaining of preflight weather information shall be in accordance with the guidance set forth in AC 91-92. In addition, NOTAMS, AIRMETS, and PIREPS must also be checked to determine if the flight can be accomplished.
    a. ***Weather data must be obtained through FAA authorized Aviation Weather sources. (See FAA Weather Handbook and the AIM for authorized sources)***
2. For all flights, the crosswind component chart or crosswind calculator will be used to determine crosswind velocity prior to the flight.
    a. The greatest reported wind (constant, gust or peak wind) will be used for the crosswind calculation.
    b. No pilot shall exceed the manufacturer's maximum demonstrated crosswind component per the AFM, POH, or IM/OM.
    c. Crosswind components may be calculated using a runway's exact magnetic azimuth as determined by the FAA within available charts (FAA airport diagram) or other authorized information systems.
3. The pilot is to compare current and forecasted weather with the weather minimums stated above to determine a go/no-go decision.
4. For conflicting weather reports, the pilot must use the more restrictive weather report to determine a go/no-go decision.
5. After a thorough weather check and a go/no-go decision has been determined, the pilot may check-in with a Dispatcher or Instructor to conduct, cancel or reschedule the flight.
6. During the preflight inspection, the pilot will check for ice, frost, or snow adhering to the above-mentioned surfaces. If the contaminant cannot be completely removed, then the flight must be cancelled or rescheduled.

PROCEDURES FOR STARTING AND TAXIING AIRCRAFT ON THE RAMP

STARTING

All US Aviation Academy aircraft shall be started in accordance with the procedures established by the Academy, and the manufacturer's AFM, POH, or IM/OM. All pilots will refer to these resources and/or checklists to ensure proper start procedures are followed.

Before starting an engine on a USAA aircraft, all pilots will ensure the following:

1. The aircraft is positioned safely and in such a manner that the prop-wash is away from hangars, windows, etc.
2. The aircraft can be safely and adequately maneuvered after engine start.
3. Visually and verbally ensure that the propeller area is clear by:
    a. Visually checking the areas in all directions to clear the propeller arc area as well as the blast area behind the aircraft.
        i. This is a deliberate process of scanning and verbally clearing "Left, Center, Right and Behind" the aircraft.
    b. Verbally call "CLEAR" or "CLEAR PROP" in a loud voice and listen for any response prior to turning on the master or ignition switches.
4. The anti-collision light(s) and/or strobes should be turned on prior to starting the engine(s).
    a. At night white strobe lights should not be activated until taxiing onto the active runway unless the white strobe light is your anti-collision light.

WARNING
All students and employees are prohibited from hand propping any aircraft while participating in any US Aviation Academy flight or ground training activity.

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CAUTION
Engine(s) shall not be started if the aircraft on either side is being fueled.

Avoid over-priming the engine before starting as this may cause an induction system fire on startup.

If the pilot is unable to start the engine, he/she should notify Dispatch and USAA Maintenance.

TAXIING

The primary requirement of safe taxiing is positive control, which we defined as: The ability to stop or turn the aircraft where and when desired.

Pilots shall taxi at speeds that always ensure safety. USAA considers the following examples as useful rules of thumb for gauging taxi speed.

In congested areas such as the ramp
- The appropriate taxi speed approximates a slow walk with as little power as necessary in order to promptly stop.

On connecting taxiways
- The appropriate taxi speed approximates a normal walking pace as appropriate

On main taxiways
- The appropriate taxi speed approximates a brisk walk

In addition to positive control while taxiing an aircraft, there are other safety practices and procedures that shall be followed as a Pilot at USAA.

1. Sterile cockpit shall be maintained while taxiing on the ramp, during take-off and landing, and other times as requested by the instructor.
   a. This means no casual radio communications or unnecessary conversation in the cockpit shall take place during this time.
2. Before the aircraft moves, before turning, before crossing on a new taxiway, before passing through intersections or hot spots, pilots shall verbally "clear on left, clear center and clear on right" or "clear on (name of taxiway/intersection)".
3. Pilots will operate only on clearly marked and paved sections of taxiways and runways.
4. The nose wheel should track along the marked centerline and in the direction indicated when taxiing on taxiways and ramp areas.

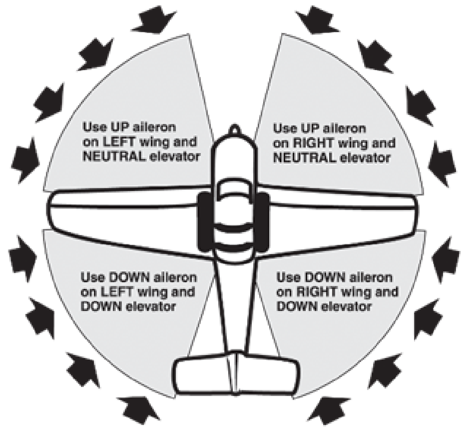
NOTE
Tracking the centerline does not guarantee clearance from all obstructions.

5. Aircraft departing the ramp shall give way to aircraft entering the ramp.
   a. When departing the ramp at night, aircraft without traditional rotating beacon may turn on the landing light or taxi light for better collision avoidance.
6. Pilots must stay in communication with ATC when in the controlled area of an airport.
7. Pilots shall comply with ATC clearances or ask for clarification before movement.
8. Pilots shall refrain from conducting the instrument cockpit check until safely clear of all ramp areas. Major taxiways are preferable when appropriate.

CAUTION
Extra care should be taken when taxiing in the proximity of people, fuel trucks or other vehicles on the ramp.

Pilots will follow the wind correction procedures as to control placement for wind. The control yoke or stick should be placed:

Quartering tailwind – full forward and away from the wind
Quartering headwind – turned into the wind
Directly behind – full forward
Directly ahead or crosswind – neutral controls



Warm Weather Operations

During warm weather operations when additional ventilation is desired inside the aircraft, a common practice is to open the aircraft door(s) to provide better cooling.

To prevent damage to the doorstop mechanism caused by propeller blast, pilots will ensure that during engine staring and taxiing, aircraft doors are securely shut or manually held off the door stop mechanism. Aircraft door(s) that are being manually held off the doorstop will not be locked in the full open position but used only when the door is completely in the closed position.

FIRE PRECAUTIONS & PROCEDURES

Fire is a serious threat to both person and property. Although rare, the possibility of a fire is present in aviation and the following fire precautions and procedures can help increase safety and diminish the risk of preventable fires.

Fire Precautions
Smoking is not permitted in company offices, vehicles, on the ramp, or in the aircraft. Designated smoking areas have been developed for smoking outside of the buildings. This prohibition includes vapor devices such as e-cigarettes.

When fueling operations are being conducted, all persons should remain clear of the aircraft and ensure that all electrical switches and ignition switches are off.

During cold weather operations, the manufacturer's cold start starting procedure shall be used while starting a USAA aircraft. In addition, if an aircraft and/or engine fire is suspected the aircraft manufacturer's procedure must be used.

CAUTION
Avoid over-priming the engine before starting as this may cause an induction system fire on startup.

The majority of induction fires occur as a result of improper priming procedures which result in a carburetor fire. Most carburetor fires can be drawn back into the engine if the proper procedure is followed.

Fire extinguishers are located on the ramp, on all fuel trucks, and in the Maintenance Hangar.

Confirmed Fire Procedure:
Upon the first recognition of a fire (aircraft, hangar, building, etc.) the following procedures should be followed:

1. Call or have someone call 911
2. Notify any person that might be endangered by the fire and see to their safety
3. If possible and safety permits, try to extinguish or contain the fire
4. If safety permits protect or move company aircraft, equipment or property which might be endangered by the fire.

Fire Extinguisher Use:
If a fire extinguisher is available, and the fire is small, try to extinguish the fire but always avoid any possibility of personal injury. This procedure is to be briefed before every engine start. If a fire extinguisher is to be used, the "**PASS**" method is the preferred procedure for extinguishing a fire.

P = Pull the pin
A = Aim at the base of the fire
S = Squeeze the handle
S = Sweep with a side to side motion at fire's base

REDISPATCH PROCEDURES AFTER UNPROGRAMMED LANDINGS

GENERAL

For re-dispatch, or to report any incident, accident or other unprogrammed event, contact your home base Dispatch at:

KDTO: 940-383-2484
KAFW: 817-515-2126
KCXO: 936-283-6006
KPOU: 518-672-1401
KCGI: 573-398-7600 ext. 201
KERV: 830-792-7496
KFFC:770-692-3777
KHYI: 346-250-1005
KBAZ: 940-297-6448 ext. 607
KIXD: 913-346-2746

ON AIRPORTS

Due to un-forecasted weather conditions, or other in-flight considerations, it may be necessary to divert and land at an airport other than the planned original or approved destination. Should this occur, Pilots shall use the following procedure:

1. Park and secure the aircraft.
2. Establish verbal and written communications with Dispatch at your home base as soon as possible to advise of aircraft location and situation.
3. If the unprogrammed landing occurred because of mechanical or aircraft performance concerns **skip to #5**.
4. If the unprogrammed landing occurred because of anything other than a mechanical or aircraft performance concern, continuation of your flight shall occur only after the following tasks are completed:
   a. The reason for the unprogrammed landing is no longer a factor or consideration.
   b. Verbal or written communications with Dispatch at your home base have been established and an updated flight plan and ETA has been discussed.
   c. Fuel needs, weather minimums and other in-flight considerations have been considered and do not prevent the flight from continuing.
5. In the event of an unprogrammed landing for mechanical or aircraft performance concerns, **STOP! DO NOT TAKE OFF AGAIN!** The aircraft is to be grounded and squawked per USAA Discrepancy Recording & Aircraft Grounding Procedures and may not be re-dispatched until released by USAA Maintenance.
6. An SMS Report shall also be submitted by the pilot(s), if appropriate.

NOTE:
Only an authorized mechanic may release an aircraft back to service after an unprogrammed landing due to a maintenance related issue.

OFF AIRPORTS

Should a landing occur at an off-airport site, the Pilot(s) should use the following procedure:

1. Secure the aircraft to prevent fire or damage.
2. Call 911
3. Establish verbal and written communications with Dispatch at your home base as soon as possible to advise of aircraft location, situation and to issue the squawk.
4. **DO NOT TAKE OFF AGAIN!**
5. The aircraft is to be grounded and squawked per USAA Discrepancy Recording & Aircraft Grounding Procedures and may not be re-dispatched until released by USAA Maintenance.
6. Dispatch is now the Point of Contact (POC) for coordinating with maintenance and any other potential person or department. The Dispatcher on duty will follow their appropriate checklist for the situation.
7. Tend to medical needs, as necessary.
8. Stay with the aircraft unless immediate help is required.
9. Stand by for further instructions. Help is coming.
10. As soon as possible, an SMS Report shall also be submitted by the pilot(s).

NOTE:
No Aircraft shall be flown after an off-airport landing until the aircraft has been released by the Director of Maintenance ***and*** *Chief/Assistant Chief Flight Instructor*

Programed Landing at a planned Airport Leading to a Maintenance and Squawking Procedures

General

After any Programed Landing at an off-airport site, where the Pilot(s) determine that there is a maintenance issue of **any** kind, the following procedure must be followed.

1. Secure the aircraft to prevent potential damage.
2. Establish verbal communication along with written communications with Dispatch at your home base as soon as possible to advise of aircraft location, situation and to issue the squawk of on the aircraft. A detailed squawk must be sent to Dispatch in email form at this time.
3. Dispatch will then check in the Pilot(s) current flight.
4. **DO NOT TAKE OFF AGAIN!**
5. Dispatch is to ground and squawk the aircraft per USAA Discrepancy Recording & Aircraft Grounding Procedures and may not be re-dispatched until released by USAA Maintenance.
6. Dispatch is now the Point of Contact (POC) for coordinating with maintenance and any other potential person or department. The Dispatcher on duty will follow their appropriate checklist for the situation.
7. Make sure your ringer is turned on and you have proper charge on your phone.
8. Stand by for further instructions and updates from POC Dispatcher. They are coordinating things for you.
9. All personnel involved should be communicating with and coordinating though the POC Dispatcher.
10. **BEFORE TAKING OFF IN THAT AIRCRAFT,** the aircraft must be re-dispatched to the Pilot(s). Re-Dispatch should only be done by the POC Dispatcher to ensure all squawks have been properly cleared and the aircraft authorized to be returned to service by proper personnel.
11. Depending on the circumstances that lead to the squawking of the aircraft, an SMS Report may also need to be submitted by the pilot(s). Check with supervisor to determine if the instance warrants a submission.

> **NOTE**:
> *No Aircraft shall be flown after a maintenance issue until the aircraft has been released by an authorized mechanic* ***and/or*** *Chief/Assistant Chief Flight Instructor*

AIRCRAFT DISCREPANCIES AND APPROVAL FOR RETURN-TO-SERVICE

AIRCRAFT DISCREPANCIES

If a pilot discovers or encounters an aircraft discrepancy in flight, on the ground or during the preflight, they will, to their best ability, attempt to communicate (in person or via phone) with maintenance personnel for further guidance.

KDTO: 940-383-2484
KAFW: 817-515-2126
KCXO: 936-283-6006
KPOU: 518-672-1401
KCGI: 573-398-7600 ext. 201
KERV: 830-792-7496
KFFC:770-692-3777
KHYI: 346-250-1005
KBAZ: 940-297-6448 ext. 607
KIXD: 913-346-2746
KFPR: 940-383-2484

If maintenance personnel are unavailable or if it is determined by the pilot or maintenance personnel that the aircraft discrepancy renders the aircraft unsafe or unairworthy, a maintenance discrepancy (or squawk as they are commonly called) will be entered into the FSP system by the instructor or submitted in writing on the dispatch sheet in the case of a student, as per USAA's **Discrepancy Recording & Aircraft Grounding Procedures**. A "**Red Tag**" will be placed on the key(s) and the keys will be handed over to the dispatcher. If the instructor cannot access FSP and/or the student cannot give the dispatch sheet to dispatch, the squawk is the be emailed to:

KAFW: adispatch@usaviationacademy.com
KDTO: dispatch@usaviationacademy.com
KCXO: cxodispatch@usaviationacademy.com
KPOU: poudispatch@usaviationacademy.com
KCGI: cgidispatch@usaviationacademy.com
KERV: ervdispatch@usaviationacademy.com
KFFC: ffcdispatch@usaviationacademy.com
KHYI: hyidispatch@usaviationacademy.com
KBAZ: bazdispatch@usaviationacademy.com
KIXD: idxdispatch@usaviationacademy.com
KFPR: fprdispatch@usaviationacademy.com

All US Aviation Academy aircraft maintenance discrepancies/squawks must be entered in Flight Schedule Pro.

An aircraft will not be dispatched until maintenance personnel have cleared all maintenance discrepancies/squawks in Flight Schedule Pro (FSP).

NOTE:
If a discrepancy occurs away from home base, refer to *REDISPATCH PROCEDURES AFTER UNPROGRAMMED LANDING.*

Determining Airworthiness & A Safe Condition to Fly

All USAA aircraft available for dispatch shall be cleared of maintenance discrepancies/squawks by USAA Maintenance personnel and deemed airworthy through compliance of Federal Aviation Regulations, Manufacture Type Certification and Airworthiness Directives. However, it is the responsibility of the pilot-in-command (PIC) to ensure that the aircraft to be flown is in a safe condition for flight.

In determining whether an aircraft is in a safe condition to fly and to the best of your knowledge, complies with all airworthiness requirements, the PIC will use the following procedure:

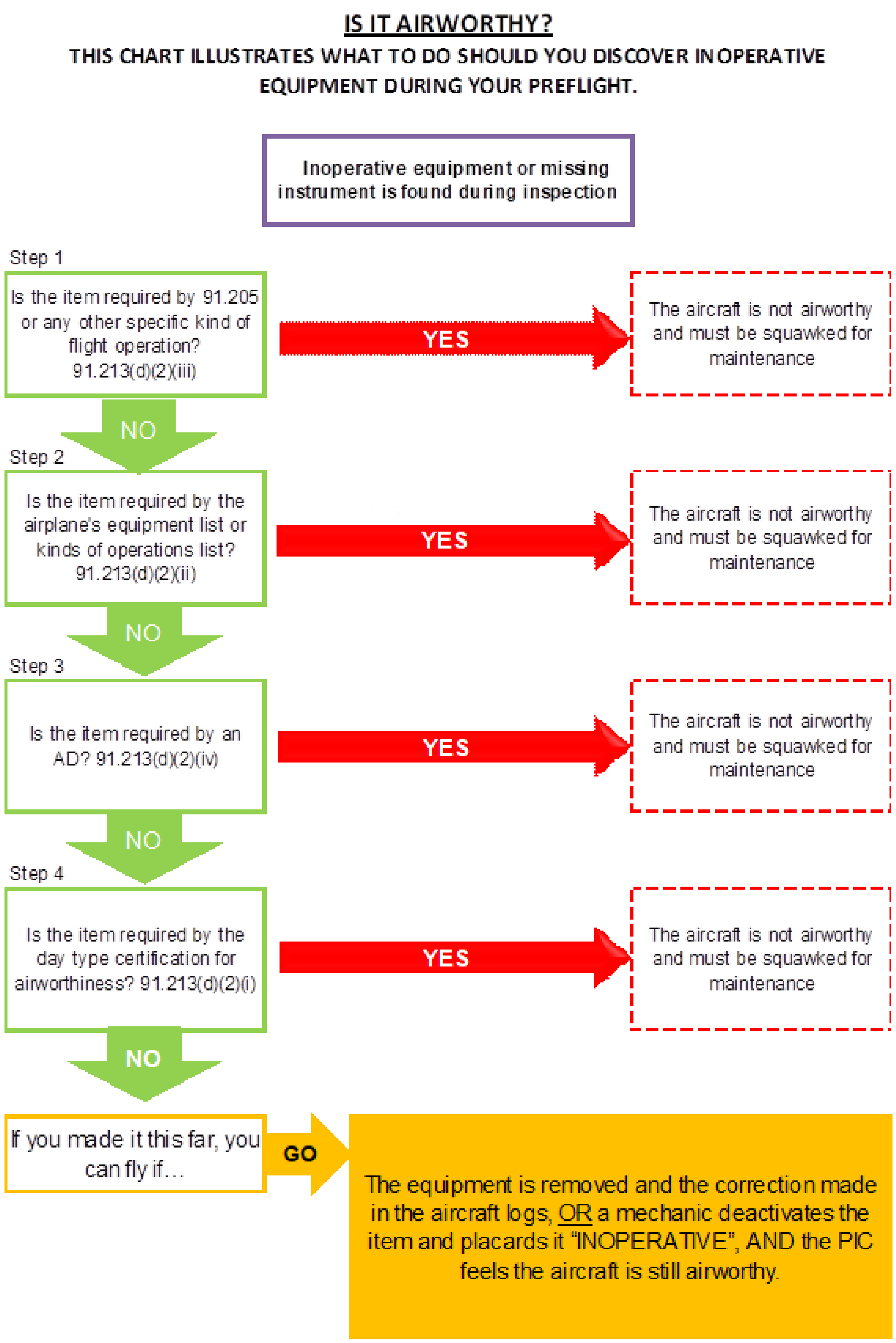
1. Using Flight Schedule Pro (FSP) the PIC will:
    a. Verify that there are no open maintenance discrepancies/squawks.
    b. Review recent maintenance discrepancies/squawks to identify trends and/or inoperative equipment.
    c. Verify tach time and/or calendar time remaining until the next inspection and/or Airworthiness Directive, as noted on the Dispatch Sheet.
    d. Pilot must select "Print Dispatch" button to view this information and verify time to the next inspection is sufficient to complete the intended flight so as not to overfly a required inspection or Airworthiness Directive.

> **NOTE**:
> *All Pilots have the option and opportunity to verify compliance and adherence to the above information in the actual aircraft maintenance logbooks. These logbooks are located in the USAA Maintenance hangar.*

2. Conduct a preflight inspection as outlined in Section 10.1 of the USAA FOM and in accordance with the Checklist for that make and model.
    a. In addition, during the preflight inspection the PIC will:
        i. Verify presence and acceptable condition of regulatory documents that must be in the aircraft.
        ii. Identify any aircraft discrepancies that may render the aircraft unsafe or unairworthy.
            1. If no discrepancies are found, no further action is needed.
            2. If a missing or inoperative equipment is found during the inspection the PIC shall refer to the Discrepancy Flow Chart located within this section.
            3. If a discrepancy is found, refer to AIRCRAFT DISCREPANCIES in this chapter.

Discrepancy Flow Chart

FAA Regulations require that all installed equipment on an aircraft must be functioning properly or deferred before an aircraft is considered to meet the specifications of type certificate.



Discrepancy Recording & Aircraft Grounding Procedures

When a determination has been made that an aircraft is unairworthy or has a discrepancy, USAA Dispatch and the PIC shall work together to record the squawk/discrepancy and ground the aircraft using the following procedure:

1. **Immediately** establish verbal or written communications with Dispatch that you intend to squawk the aircraft.
    a. Dispatch will remove subsequent flights assigned to that aircraft and place a maintenance block on the aircraft in Flight Schedule Pro.
2. **Instructors** will input the discrepancy into FSP immediately.

    Students will provide dispatch with an email or notate the discrepancy on the dispatch sheet that they would return to the Dispatch desk immediately.

    Instructors and Students will provide the following information in the discrepancy:
    a. PIC Name
    b. PIC cell phone number
    c. Description of the discrepancy
    d. Additional details that will help maintenance trouble shoot. (IE. inflight, low idle, etc.)
3. The keys are turned into dispatch directly, **not** the *Keyper* System.
    a. Solo students will turn in the paper dispatch with the squawk written on it along with the keys to dispatch.
4. Dispatch will then place a **red tag** from the red tag box onto the key chain.
5. USAA Dispatch will then enter the "squawk" into FSP as provided by the student and/or verify with the instructor that they have entered the discrepancy into FSP.
6. Dispatch will follow all other necessary steps for the discrepancy as per their specific Dispatch SOP.
7. **Pilots and Dispatchers are to verify that all discrepancies have made it into the FSP system.**

NOTE:
*Dispatch will clip a **RED TAG** onto the set of keys belonging to the aircraft that is squawked.*

How to determine an "elevated" squawk. (Maintenance will verify every squawk for elevation)

1. In accordance with USAA Maintenance Procedures, they will look back at the previous 50 hours of flight time in FSP to determine if the current discrepancy matches any others reported during that time frame. If so, it is to be reported as an "elevated" squawk.
    a. Quick reference for this is to look at everything prior to the most recent 50 and 100-hour inspections. If the most recent inspection was a 50 hour, all squawks since the most recent 100 hour should be examined. If the most recent inspection was a 100 hour, all squawks since the most recent 50 hour should be examined.
2. USAA Maintenance will enter all "elevated" squawks into FSP beginning with "****Elevated Squawk****" to ensure the proper attention is given to the appropriate maintenance personnel.
3. Maintenance personnel are to follow the "elevated" squawk procedures as per their current manual. **Maintenance will verify all squawks for elevation when assigned the aircraft**. All squawks will be checked against previous squawks for that aircraft to determine if it is an elevated squawk.
4. Elevated squawks can only be cleared by the Director of Maintenance, Repair Station Managers, the Chief Inspector or be designated by the maintenance Director.

Return to Service Procedures

When an aircraft has received approval by USAA Maintenance to return to service after being grounded for a discrepancy/squawk, USAA Maintenance and USAA Dispatch shall work together to make the aircraft available for dispatch using the following procedure:

1. USAA Maintenance will enter the discrepancy/squawk resolutions and repair details in FSP.
2. USAA Maintenance personnel will return the aircraft keys, if necessary, to USAA Dispatch.
3. USAA Dispatch will ensure the squawk is cleared in FSP, Remove the Red Tag, and return the aircraft to normal status in the Keyper System.

If a pilot receives a set of keys with a **RED TAG** on it, **DO NOT FLY!** Please notify the dispatcher of the situation. The dispatcher will take the keys from you and assign another aircraft if necessary. Dispatchers are the responsible party for determining what the issue is and why there is a red tag still on the keys. Dispatch may remove the Red Tag once the aircraft is determined airworthy.

NOTE:
*Under no circumstance shall you fly an aircraft with a **RED TAG** still on the keys.*

SECURING OF AIRCRAFT WHEN NOT IN USE

Pilots must ensure that the aircraft is parked and properly secured. The aircraft must be positioned, as appropriate to the spot, directly over the tie downs. The wing rope tie downs should oppose the tail rope. Only the "USAA Knot" is authorized when securing aircraft.

PARKING THE AIRCRAFT

- When parking aircraft on the ramp, pilots will exercise extreme caution to ensure adequate clearance between aircraft.

- Pilots are to taxi up perpendicular to the securing spot, shutdown and use the tow bar to move the aircraft into its securing spot.

> **CAUTION**
> *Extreme vigilance is necessary to avoid colliding with other aircraft while moving the aircraft into its securing spot.*

- Students are prohibited from pushing back Cessna 172's using the tow bar. Flight instructors are to handle the tow bar while the students may assist pushing back from a wing (strut).
  - Exception: Students who during their training will utilize a Cessna 172 for solo flight, may under the supervision of their flight instructor, receive training on proper parking and pushback procedures to include manning the tow bar. Students completing solo missions in Cessna 172 may use the tow bar if training and standardization by an authorized instructor has been accomplished.

SECURING THE AIRCRAFT

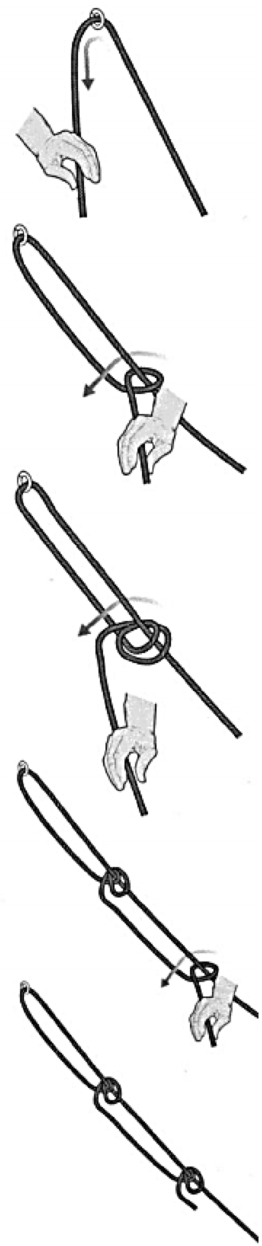
- Aircraft controls will be secured when parked, regardless of wind conditions. If the aircraft has a control lock installed, it will be used.
  - If there is no control lock, use the seat belt to secure the control yoke.
- Seatbelts that do not automatically retract will be neatly secured across the seat. If there is no control lock, use the seat belt to secure the control yoke.
- Only the "USAA knot" is authorized when securing aircraft.
- Tie-downs will be properly attached to all US Aviation Academy aircraft any time the aircraft is left unattended.
- When exiting the aircraft, ensure that all switches are off, and all trash and personal items are removed from the aircraft.
- Pitot covers and stall plugs will be used whenever available.
- All windows and air vents will be fully closed and secured.

> **NOTE**
> *It is the responsibility of the Pilot-In-Command to ensure that the aircraft is properly secured at the completion of each flight.*

USAA Knot

Pilots will use the Double Half-Hitch knot according to the following diagram:

1. Run rope through the tiedown eyelet from the back of the airplane to the front.
2. Circle the line around and through to form the first of two half-hitches, six to 12 inches from the airplane's tiedown eyelet.
3. Repeat to form a second half-hitch, pulling the line around and over the first, then locking it under the first with a sharp tug.
4. Now form a second set of halfhitches, six to 12 inches below the first set. by repeating steps 2 and 3.
5. The two sets of half-hitches are complete. For best results, use proper line and solid ground attachment points.



FUEL RESERVES

Fuel considerations are a critical part of every flight. Only through proper preflight planning will Pilots know the fuel requirements for a flight. Fuel requirement considerations become increasingly important when poor meteorological conditions exist, or unexpected delays effect your flight. Having the appropriate fuel reserves is a critical safety measure that shall not be omitted by USAA pilots.

The aircraft fuel requirements are to be determined by the oncoming flight crew.

VFR & IFR LOCAL FLIGHT FUEL REQUIREMENTS

Notwithstanding FAR fuel requirements, aircraft departing for a local flight must have the minimum fuel capacity to complete the mission plus 45 min reserve.

VFR & IFR CROSS-COUNTRY FLIGHT FUEL REQUIREMENTS

Aircraft departing on cross-country flights must have maximum allowable fuel on board as per weight and balance and performance calculations. All flights shall be planned in such a way as to allow the reaching of the destination with no less than 45 minutes of reserve fuel left onboard.

AVOIDANCE OF OTHER AIRCRAFT

IN FLIGHT

All flight crews shall maintain a continuous, vigilant watch for other traffic as the primary means of collision avoidance when flying in visual meteorological conditions (VMC). Flight crews should consider the following:

- Keep attention outside the aircraft as much as possible. Be alert for distractions that may draw attention away from outside visual scanning. When flying with passengers they should be encouraged to assist with lookout.
- Visually scan from as far behind as reasonable, sweeping in 20° increments around the front of the aircraft to as far behind as reasonable on the other side.
- Be aware of potential blind spots inherent to the type of aircraft flown. Make no turns without first scanning the area that may be blocked out by either wing. Make gentle turns left and right as necessary when climbing or descending to help see past the aircraft engine cowling. Be prepared to react appropriately to avoid a collision hazard by remaining in a normal flying position with hands and feet on the proper controls.
- Be especially alert for any aircraft in flight that appears on the horizon to be growing in size and remaining in the same relative position in the windshield. This aircraft is on a collision course. Take prompt action to avoid any possible traffic conflicts. Observe right-of-way regulations, but do not create a collision hazard by insisting on right-of-way.
- The anti-collision light(s) (strobe and/or beacon) must be ON during operations on the runway and in-flight. Landing lights must also be ON during takeoff and landing operations, when the flight visibility is below five (5) miles and in the vicinity of the landing airport (10 nm). In addition, the landing light(s) may be utilized in other flight operations to enhance the "see and avoid" concept.
- Flight crews should be especially alert to the hazards of wake turbulence while conducting operations near larger aircraft. Pilots should note the rotation or touchdown point of the preceding aircraft. This will help the crew to visualize the wake location and thereby take appropriate avoidance precautions.
- Flight crews must be familiar with all obstruction locations in the local area, as well as any along the planned route of flight.
- Pilots are reminded to use the appropriate recommended traffic pattern entry procedures.

ON THE GROUND

- All students and instructors shall refrain from conducting the instrument cockpit check until safely on the main taxiways.
- On congested or busy ramps, taxi at a cautious speed so when the throttle is closed the airplane can be stopped promptly.
- Prior to entering the runway ensure the runway and final approach path is clear. After landing, maintain control of aircraft, slow down, and cautiously taxi off the runway onto the taxiway. Stop after crossing the hold line, (unless given different instructions) and accomplish your after-landing checklist. Maintain lights as needed and properly clear the taxi area before moving the aircraft.
- All students and instructors will adhere to taxi callouts at all times (left clear, center clear, right clear).

MINIMUM ALTITUDE LIMITATIONS

GENERAL

The minimum altitudes to be flown for all normal operations at US Aviation Academy are in accordance with 14 CFR 91.119. However, if at any time, for any reason, the aircraft is forced to fly outside of this regulation, a written report MUST BE MADE IMMEDIATELY upon landing. This report shall be in accordance with US Aviation Academy internal procedures and the NASA Aviation Safety Reporting System.

Except when necessary for takeoff or landing, no person may operate an aircraft below the following altitudes:

Anywhere:
- An altitude allowing, if a power unit fails, an emergency landing without undue hazard to persons or property on the surface.

Over congested areas:
- Over any congested area of a city, town, or settlement, or over any open-air assembly of persons, an altitude of 1,000 feet above the highest obstacle within a horizontal radius of 2,000 feet of the aircraft.

Over other than congested areas:
- An altitude of 500 feet above or around any person or obstacle and never below 500 feet of the surface.

VFR MANEUVERING

Maneuvers in single-engine airplanes (except ground reference maneuvers and demonstrated stalls) will be conducted at an altitude higher than 2000 feet AGL. Maneuvers in multi-engine airplanes will be conducted above 3000 feet AGL. All demonstrated stalls will be conducted above 3000 feet AGL.

For training, spins must be done with an approved instructor on board, with the provision that the maneuver is recovered by a minimum altitude of 4000 feet AGL. Additionally, the instructor must have management approval to conduct spin training in USAA Aircraft. The procedures to follow for conducting spins is the USAA SEL Maneuvers Guide. In the event of a spin adversely occurring during the normal course of training, the PIC should execute the recover procedure using the PARE acronym as per the USAA SEL Guide.

Additional limitations are imposed for multi-engine aircraft operations. Vmc demos, Drag demos, and multi engine shutdown procedures, will be initiated from an altitude greater than 4000 feet AGL.

The minimum planned altitude for VFR navigation shall ensure compliance with 14 CFR 91.119 & 91.159. Pilots are also to consider controlled airspace and special use airspace in their planning.

IFR Maneuvering

For IFR flights, pilots are reminded of the need to comply with 14 CFR 91.177 & 91.179. It is essential that all flight crews are aware of the correct method for calculating minimum altitudes for their flight.

Simulated Emergency Landing Instructions

Simulated emergency approach and landing operations may be conducted only during dual flight instructional periods. In addition, they must be performed in accordance with the appropriate US Aviation Academy *Maneuvers Guides.*

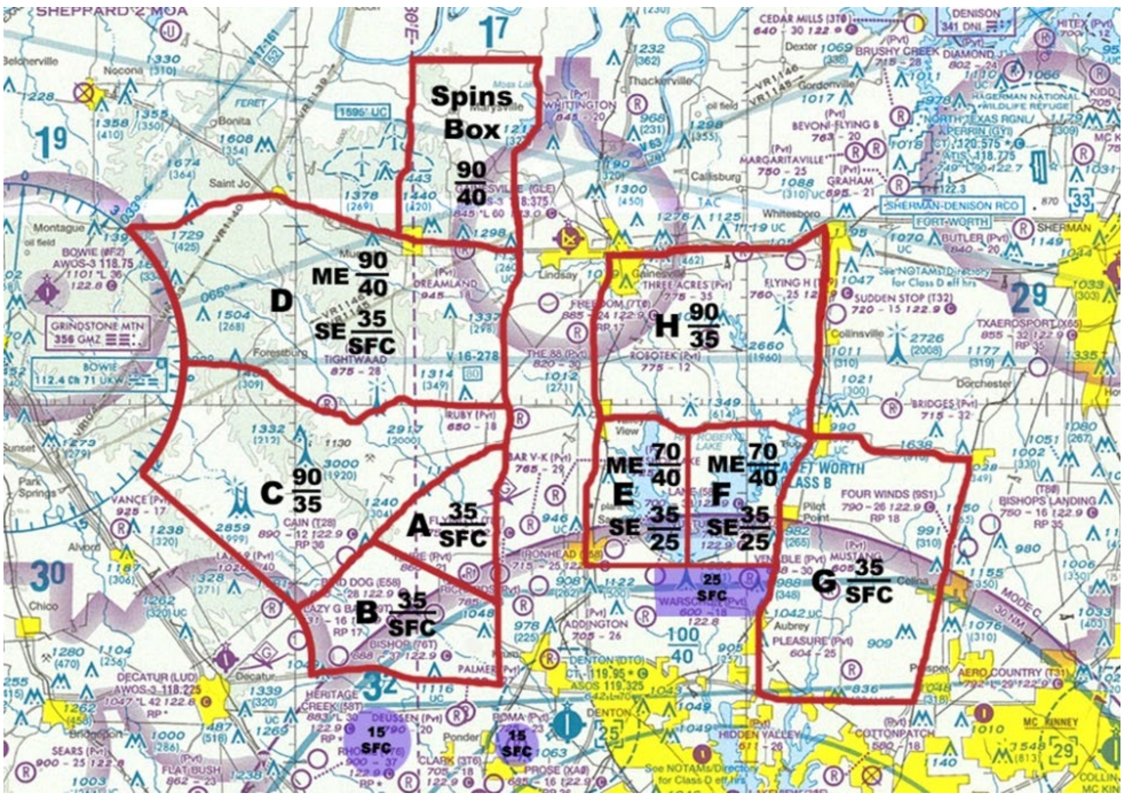
During simulated forced landings at locations other than an approved public-use airport, go around action must be taken no lower than 500 feet AGL. Care must be taken to avoid populated areas.

ASSIGNED PRACTICE AREAS

Flight training will normally take place within the boundaries of the designated practice areas for the respective base of operations. Please refer to operations base and the associated map and description of the practice areas.

At all times when in the practice areas, pilots will monitor the respective practice area frequency and report their position prior to executing maneuvers. Pilots will maintain situational awareness while in the practice area and exercise caution if it becomes apparent that other aircraft are in close proximity to each other. In this case it must be agreed between the pilots that one aircraft shall choose another area to operate within.

DENTON (KDTO)



DTO Practice Area Descriptions					
Area	Northern Boundary	Eastern Boundary	Southern Boundary	Western Boundary	Altitude
A	Highway 922	5 Miles West of I-35	UKW Radial 110	Highway 51	SFC-3500 ft.
B	UKW Radial 110	5 Miles West of I-35	Highway 380	Highway 51	SFC-3500 ft.
C	Highway 922	Highway 51	UKW Radial 110	UKW 10 DME	3500-9000 ft.
D	Highway 82	5 Miles West of I-35	Highway 922	UKW 10 DME	3500-9000 ft.
E1 (ME)	Highway 922	Lake R.R. Peninsula	Highway 455 (R.R. Dam)	I-35	4000-7000 ft.
E2 (SE)	Highway 922	Lake R.R. Peninsula	Highway 455 (R.R. Dam)	I-35	2500-3500 ft.
F1 (ME)	Highway 922	Highway 377	Highway 455 (R.R. Dam)	Lake R.R. Peninsula	4000-7000 ft.
F2 (SE)	Highway 922	Highway 377	Highway 455 (R.R. Dam)	Lake R.R. Peninsula	2500-3500 ft.
G	Highway 922	Highway 289	Highway 380	Highway 377	SFC-3500 ft.
H	Highway 82	Highway 377	Highway 922	I-35	3500-9000 ft.

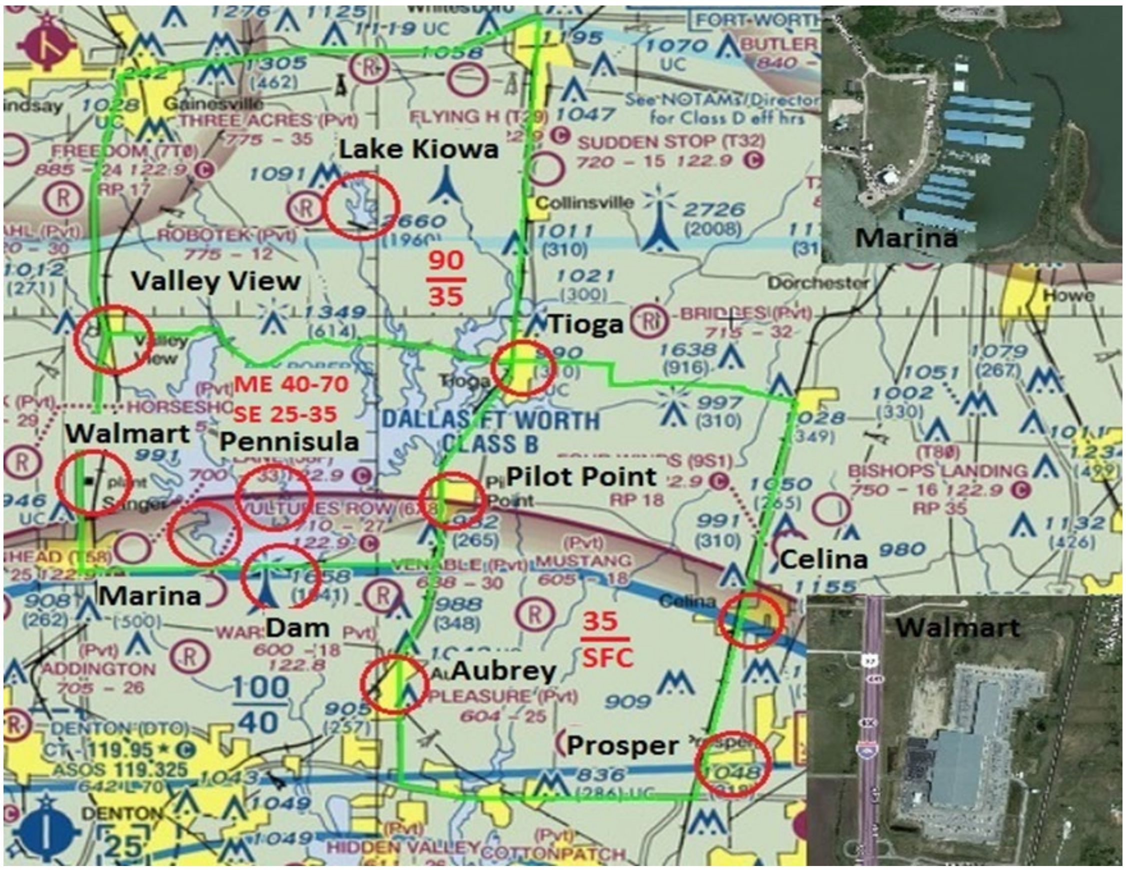
DTO Practice Area Frequency - 123.30:

US Aviation Academy DTO practice area frequency will be used operating in the Northwest practice area, the North practice area and the Northeast practice in airspace areas A, B, C, D, E, F, G, H, and the spin box.

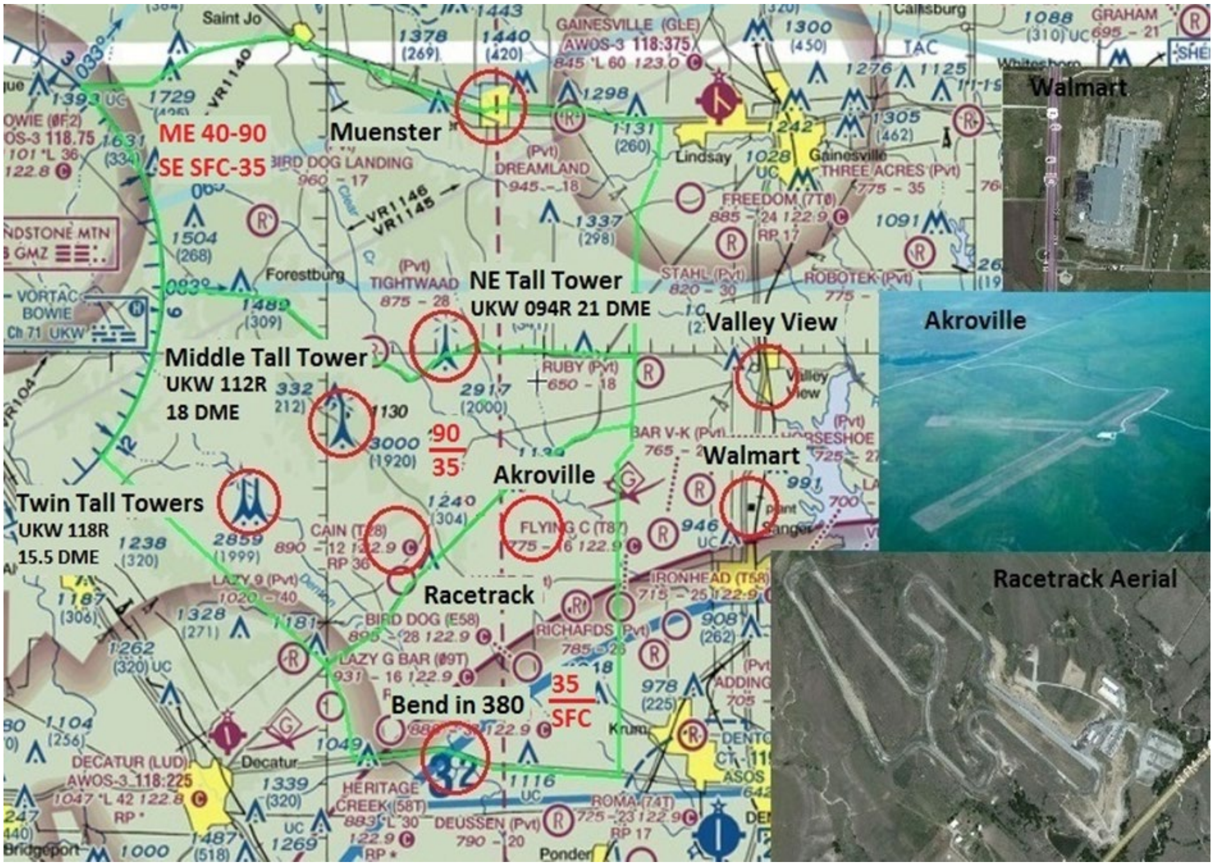
Approaches are conducted at DTO and airports around Northern Texas and Oklahoma.

Denton Practice Area Reporting Points

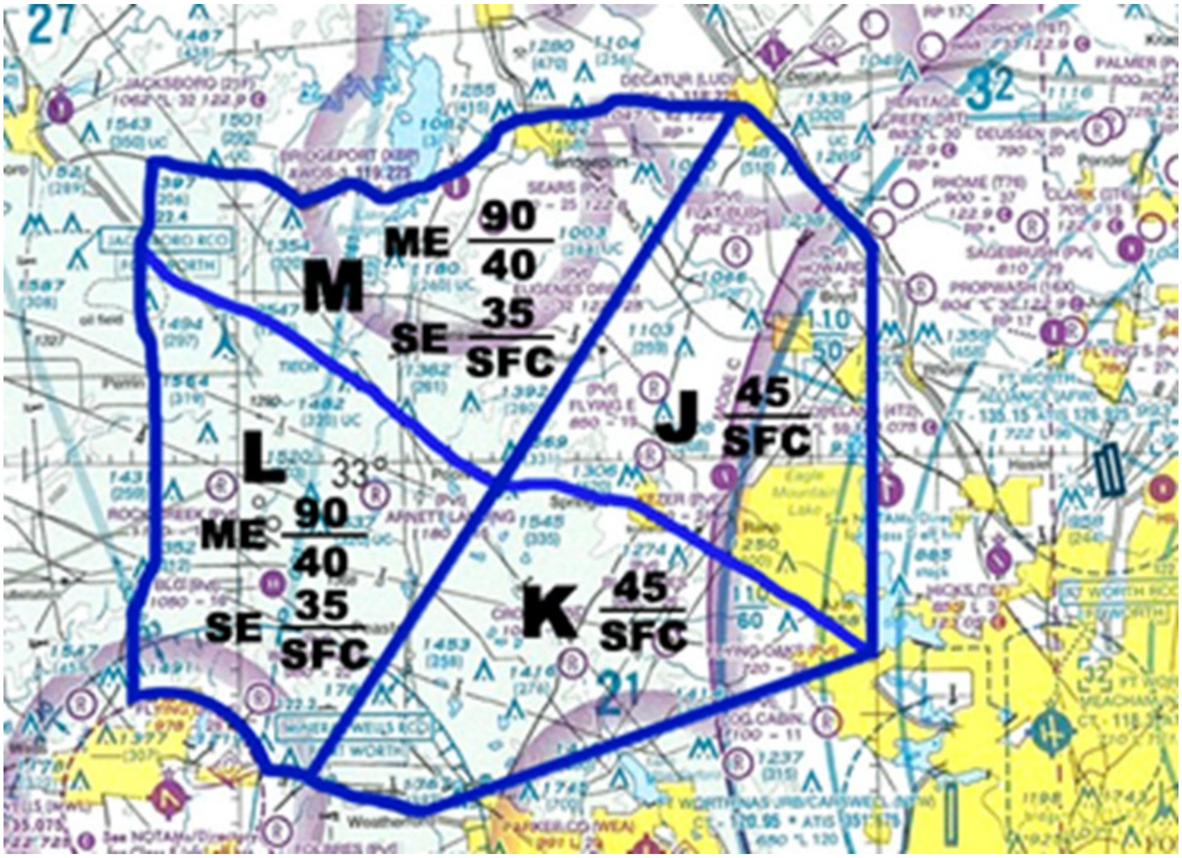
NORTHEAST PRACTICE AREAS



NORTHWEST PRACTICE AREAS



ALLIANCE (KAFW)



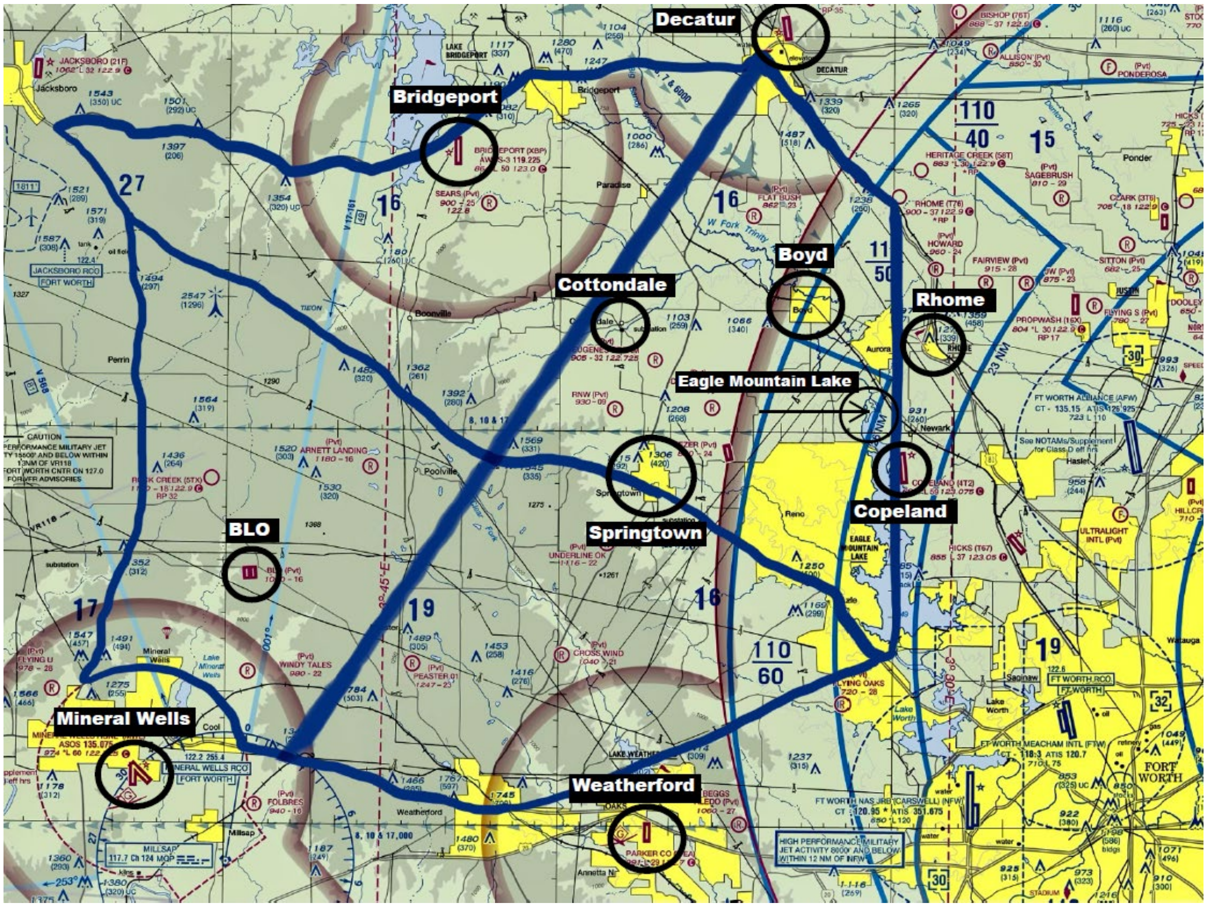
Area	Northern Boundary	Eastern Boundary	Southern Boundary	Western Boundary	Altitude
J	Highway 81	Eagle Mountain Lake	Highway 199	MQP Radial 025	SFC-4500 ft.
K	Highway 199	MQP Radial 062	Highway 180	MQP Radial 025	SFC-4500 ft.
L1 (ME)	Highway 199	MQP Radial 025	KMWL Class E & 180	Highway 281	4000-9000 ft.
L2 (SE)	Highway 199	MQP Radial 025	KMWL Class E & 180	Highway 281	SFC-3500 ft.
M1 (ME)	Highway 380	MQP Radial 025	Highway 199	Highway 281	4000-9000 ft.
M2 (SE)	Highway 380	MQP Radial 025	Highway 199	Highway 281	SFC-3500 ft.

AFW Practice Area Frequency – 122.775:

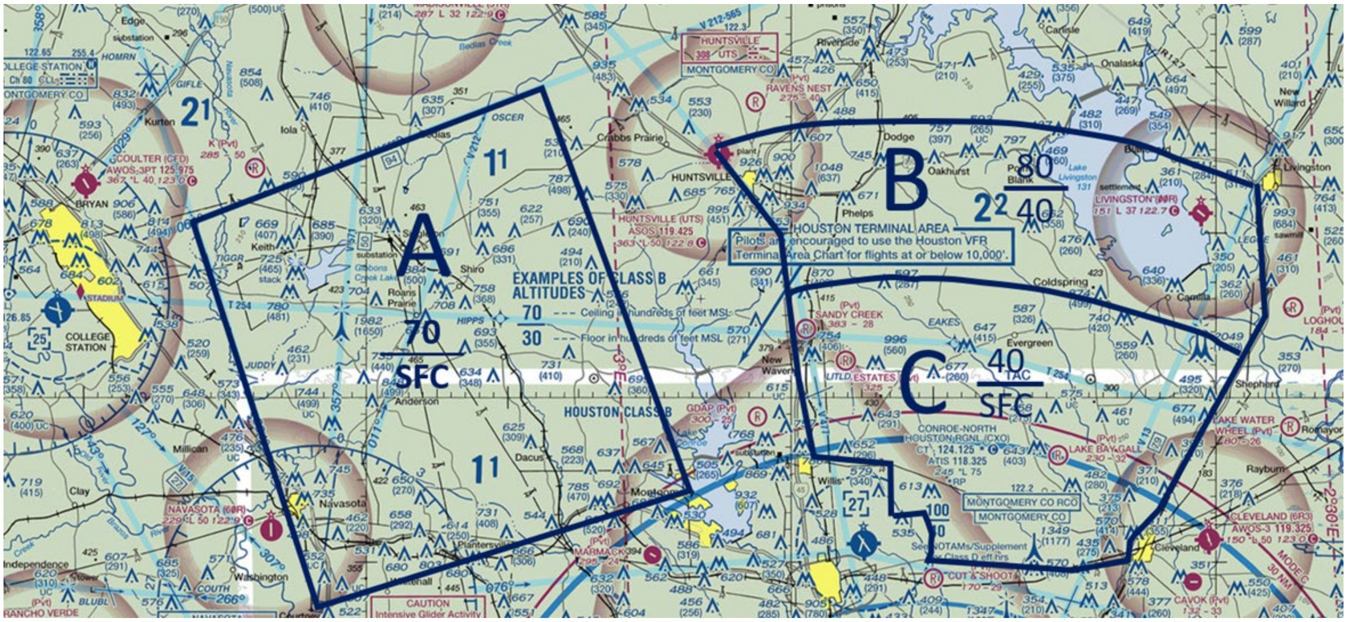
US Aviation Academy AFW practice area frequency will be used operating in the Northwest practice area, the North practice area and the Northeast practice in airspace areas J, K, L, M.

Approaches are conducted at AFW and airports around Northern Texas and Oklahoma.

Alliance Practice Area Reporting Points



CONROE (KCXO)



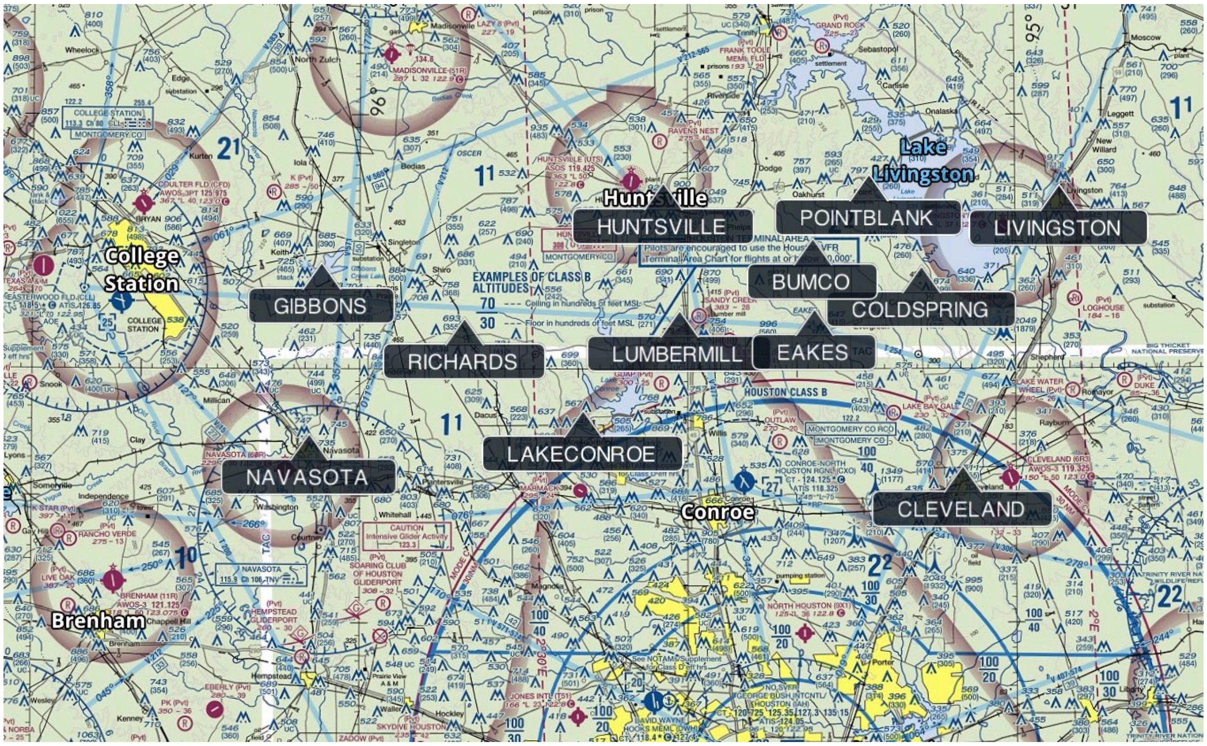
Area	Northern Boundary	Eastern Boundary	Southern Boundary	Western Boundary	Altitude
A	CLL 067°R	LOA 148°R	TNV 065°R	TNV 334°R	SFC-8000 Ft.
B	IAH 49DME ARC	Hwy 59	IAH 40DME ARC	IH 45	4000-8000 Ft
C	IAH 40DME ARC	Hwy 59	Hwy 105	IH 45	SFC-4000 Ft

CXO Practice Area Frequency – 122.725

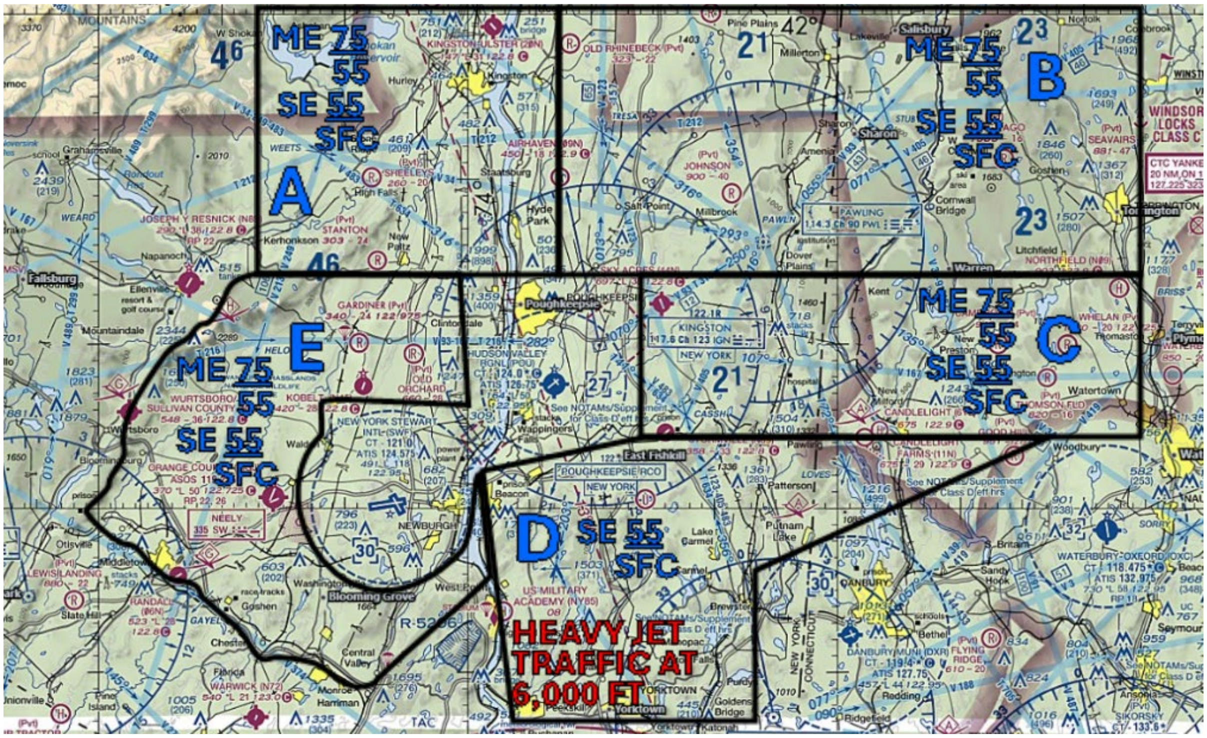
US Aviation Academy CXO practice area frequency will be used operating in the Northwest practice area and the Northeast practice area in airspace A, B and C.

Approaches are conducted at KCXO and airports around Southeast Texas.

Conroe Practice Area Reporting Points



HUDSON VALLEY REGIONAL (KPOU)

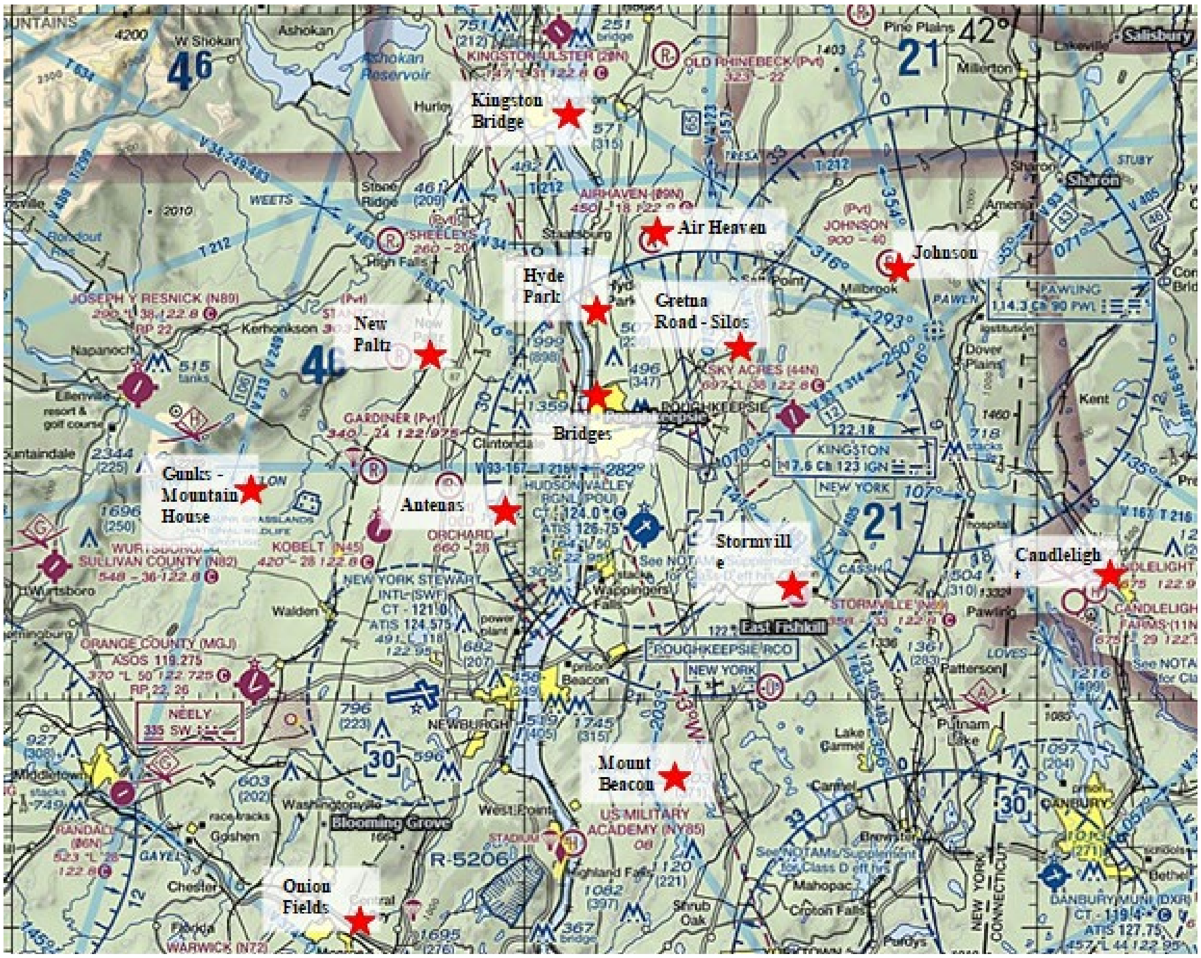


Area	Northern Boundary	Eastern Boundary	Southern Boundary	Western Boundary	Altitude
A	Town of Kingston / 20N, Rhinecliff-Kingston Bridge, Ashokan Reservoir	Town of Red Hook, Route 9	Marist College, Route 199 into New Paltz	Ashokan Reservoir, 5 E of Resnick Ellenville **(Remain East of the Mountain Ridge)**	SE - SFC-5500 ft. ME – 5500 ft. – 7500 ft.
B	Town of Red Hook, Pine Plains, North Canaan	Town of Winsted, CT, Town of Torrington, CT	2 miles NE of Sky Acres, City of Poughkeepsie, Town of Kent, Town of Litchfield	Town of Red Hook, Route 9	SE - SFC-5500 ft. ME – 5500 ft. – 7500 ft.
C	2 miles NE of Sky Acres, Town of Kent, Town of Litchfield	Route 8 (From Torrington to Waterbury / Waterbury)	Stormville (N69), Town of Pawling, Town of Waterbury	Taconic State Parkway, Sky Acres (44N) & Stormville (N69) Airport	SE - SFC-5500 ft. ME – 5500 ft. – 7500 ft.
D	Interstate 84, Stormville Airport (N69), Town of Pawling	Town of Brewster, Putnam Lake, Woodbury (Remaining outside Waterbury and Danbury Airports)	West Point Military Academy, R-5206, Indian Point Nuclear Energy Plant, Bear Mountain Bridge, Town of Yorktown	Hudson River, Bear Mountain Bridge	SE and ME- SFC-5500 ft (see Special Considerations pg 39)
E	Marist College, Route 199 into New Paltz	East boundary: KSWF Airspace, I-87 until Harriman, the Hudson River	South boundary: Randal 06N and following Rte 6 until West Point Military Academy, R-5206	West boundary: The Shawangunk mountain ridge from the Mountain House until Middle Town	SE - SFC-5500 ft. ME – 5500 ft. – 7500 ft.

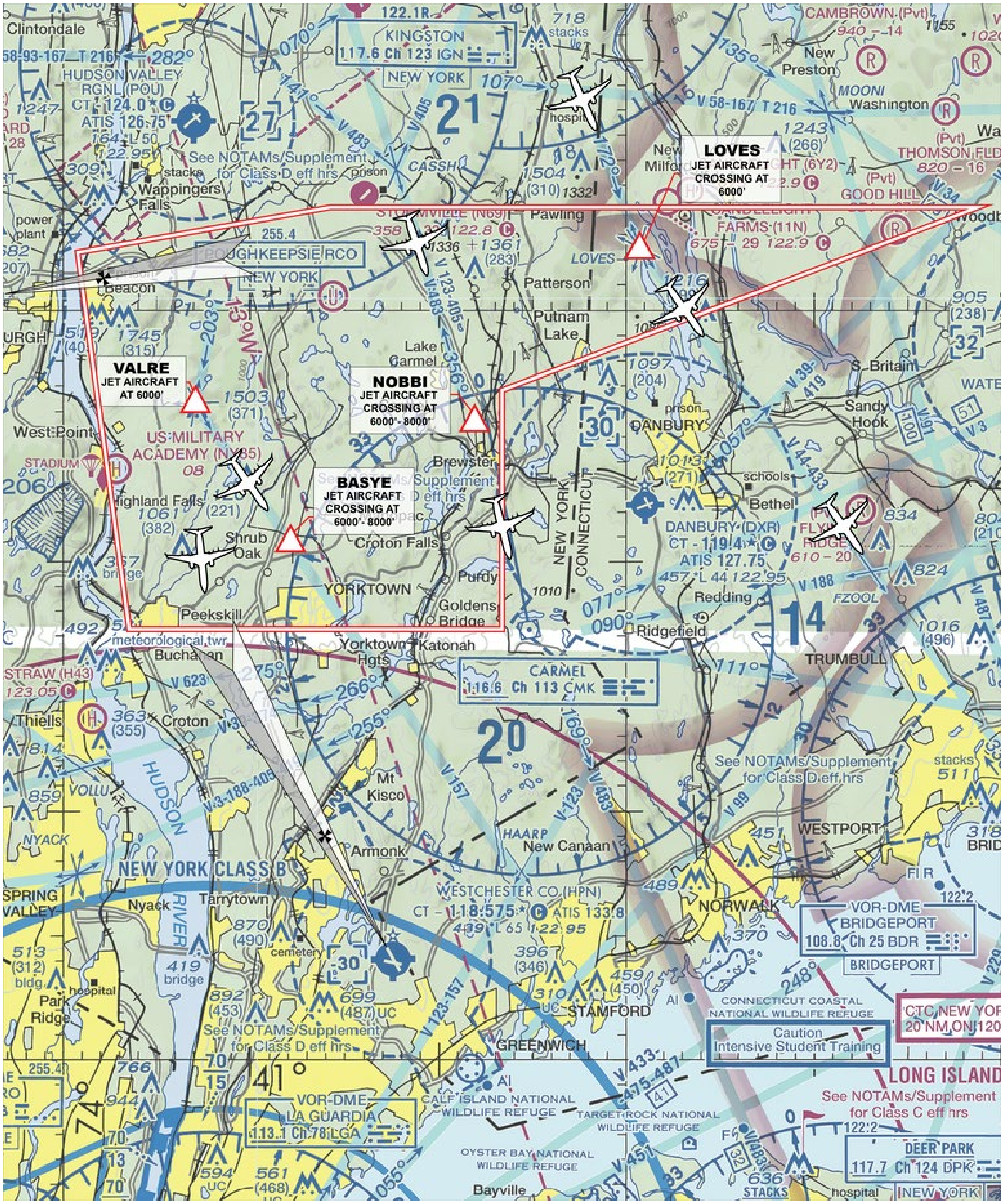
POU Practice Area Frequency – 122.750

US Aviation Academy POU practice area frequency will be used when operating in all of the above.

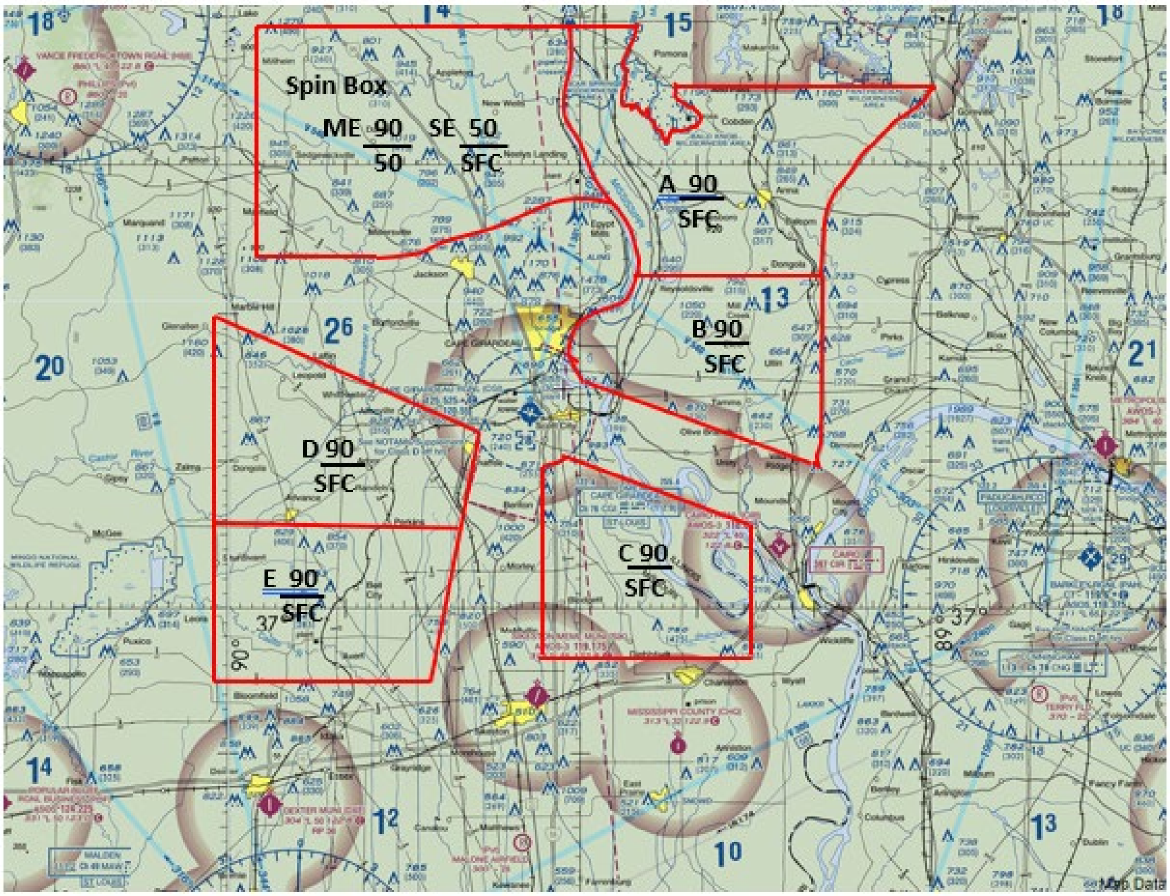
Poughkeepsie Practice Area Reporting Points



Poughkeepsie Practice Area D Special Considerations



CAPE GIRARDEAU (KCGI)

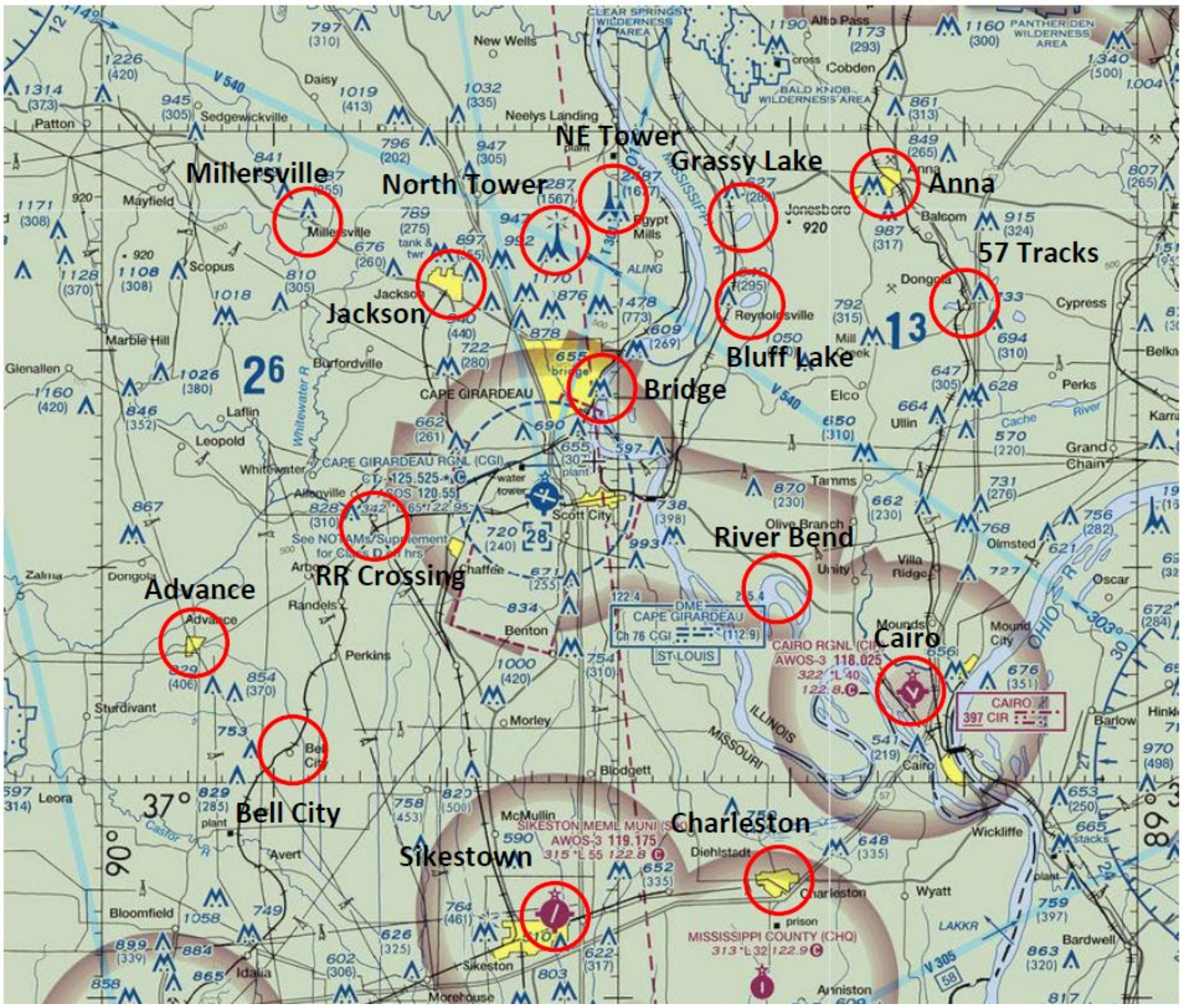


Area	Northern Boundary	Eastern Boundary	Southern Boundary	Western Boundary	Altitude
A	Wilderness Area, Alto Pass	Interstate 57	Bluff Lake	Mississippi River	SFC-9000 ft.
B	Bluff Lake	Interstate 57	CNG Radial 297 CNG 18 DME	Mississippi, Class Delta	SFC-9000 ft.
C	280 Radial CNG	CNG Radial 280 CNG 20.5 DME	2.5 North of KSIK	North of KSIK, 0.5 miles West of I-55	SFC-9000 ft.
D	280 Radial CNG	Class E SFR	Town of Advance (South)	FAM Radial 154 FAM 22.5 DME	SFC-9000 ft.
E	Town of Advance	MAW Radial 020 MAW 23.5 DME	North of KSIK	MAW Radial 345 MAW 22.2 DME	SFC-9000 ft.
Spin & ME Box	FAM Radial 090 FAM 13.2 DME	Mississippi River	Town of Jackson	FAM Radial 140 FAM 20.8 DME	Spin / ME 5000-9000 ft. SE (SFC-5000 ft.)

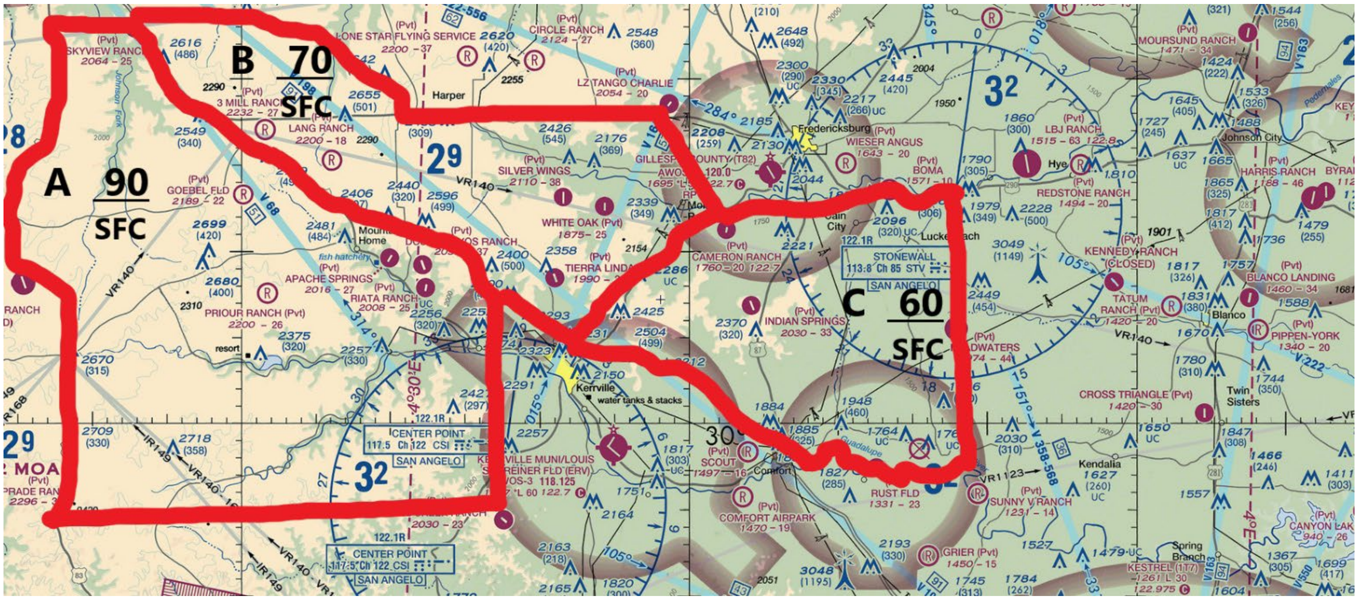
CGI Practice Area Frequency – 122.750

US Aviation Academy CGI practice area frequency will be used when operating in all of the above.

Girardeau Practice Area Reporting Points



KERRVILLE (KERV)

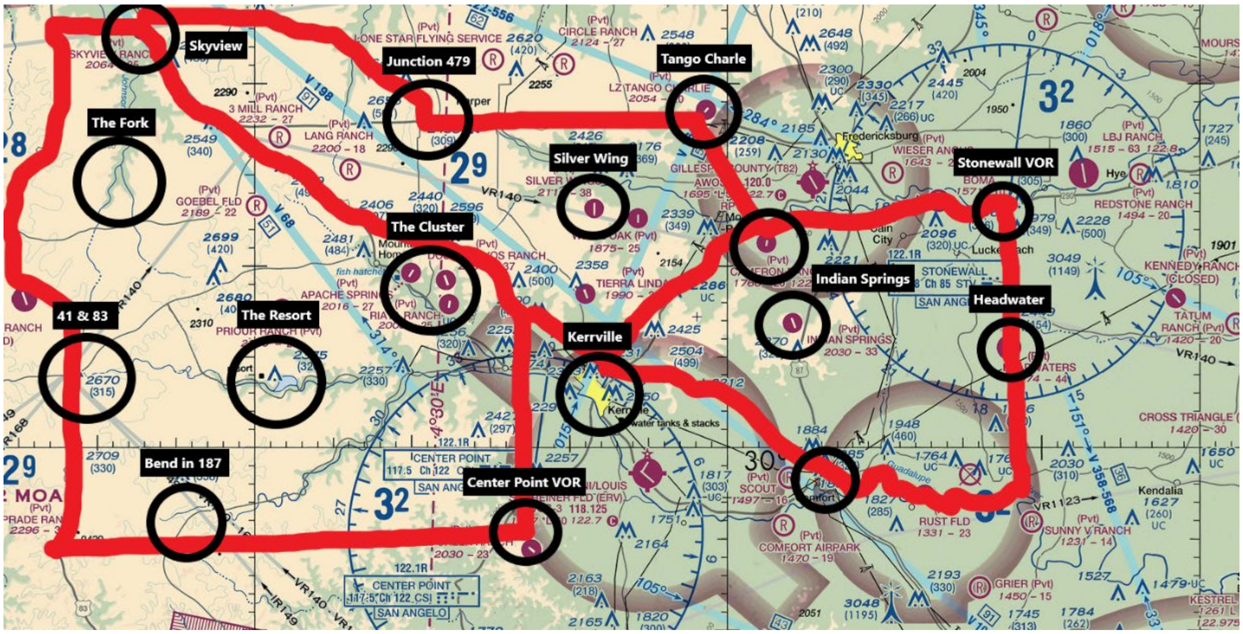


Area	Northern Boundary	Eastern Boundary	Southern Boundary	Western Boundary	Altitude
A	Interstate 10	Interstate 10	260 Deg Radial off CSI	HWY 83	SFC - 9000 ft.
B	FM 479 & HWY 290	Line from LZ Tango Charle to Cameron Ranch, Cameron to Kerrville along TX HWY 16	Interstate 10	Interstate 10	SFC - 7000 ft.
C	Pedernales River	170 Deg Radial off STV to Guadalupe River	Guadalupe River	Interstate 10 from Comfort to Kerrville, Line from Kerrville to Cameron Ranch along TX HWY 16	SFC - 6000 ft.

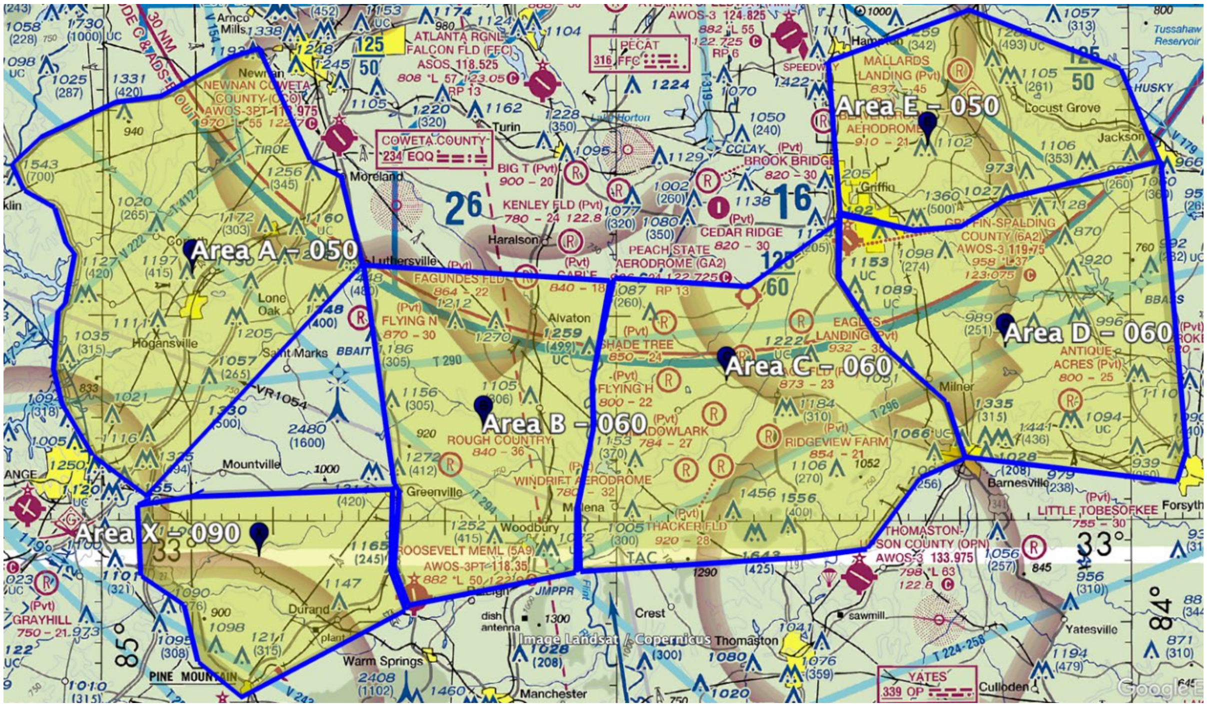
ERV Practice Area Frequency – 122.750

US Aviation Academy ERV practice area frequency will be used when operating in all of the above

Kerrville Practice Areas and Reporting Points



FALCON FIELD (KFFC)

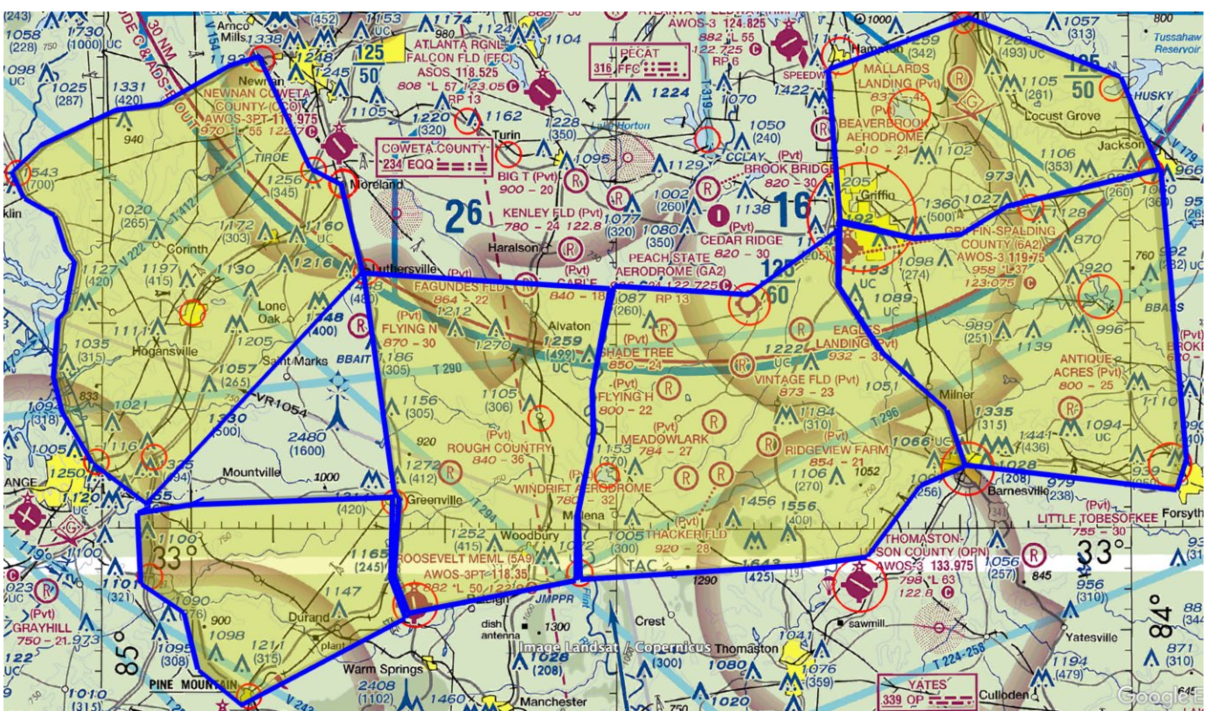


Area	Northern	Western	Southern	Eastern	Altitude
A	GA-34 from W edge of Newnan to intersection with US-17	US-27 to I-85 then straight line to I-185	2 NM SE of I-85 from Town of Luthersville to I-185	W. edge of Newnan to intersection of I-85 and E/W powerlines to Town of Moreland along US-29 to Town of Luthersville	Up to 5,000 MSL
B	Town of Luthersville E toward Peach State Aerodrome (GA2) stopping at Flint River	US-29 from Luthersville to Greenville to Roosevelt (5A9)	Roosevelt (5A9) to big bend in Flint River	Flint River	Up to 6,000 MSL
C	E/W line from Luthersville to Peach State Aerodrome beginning at Flint River continuing to Peach State then turning to	Flint River to big bend in the river	Straight line between big bend in Flint River east to Thomaston Airport, then following powerlines to Barnesville	US-41 between Griffin and Barnesville	Up to 6,000 MSL

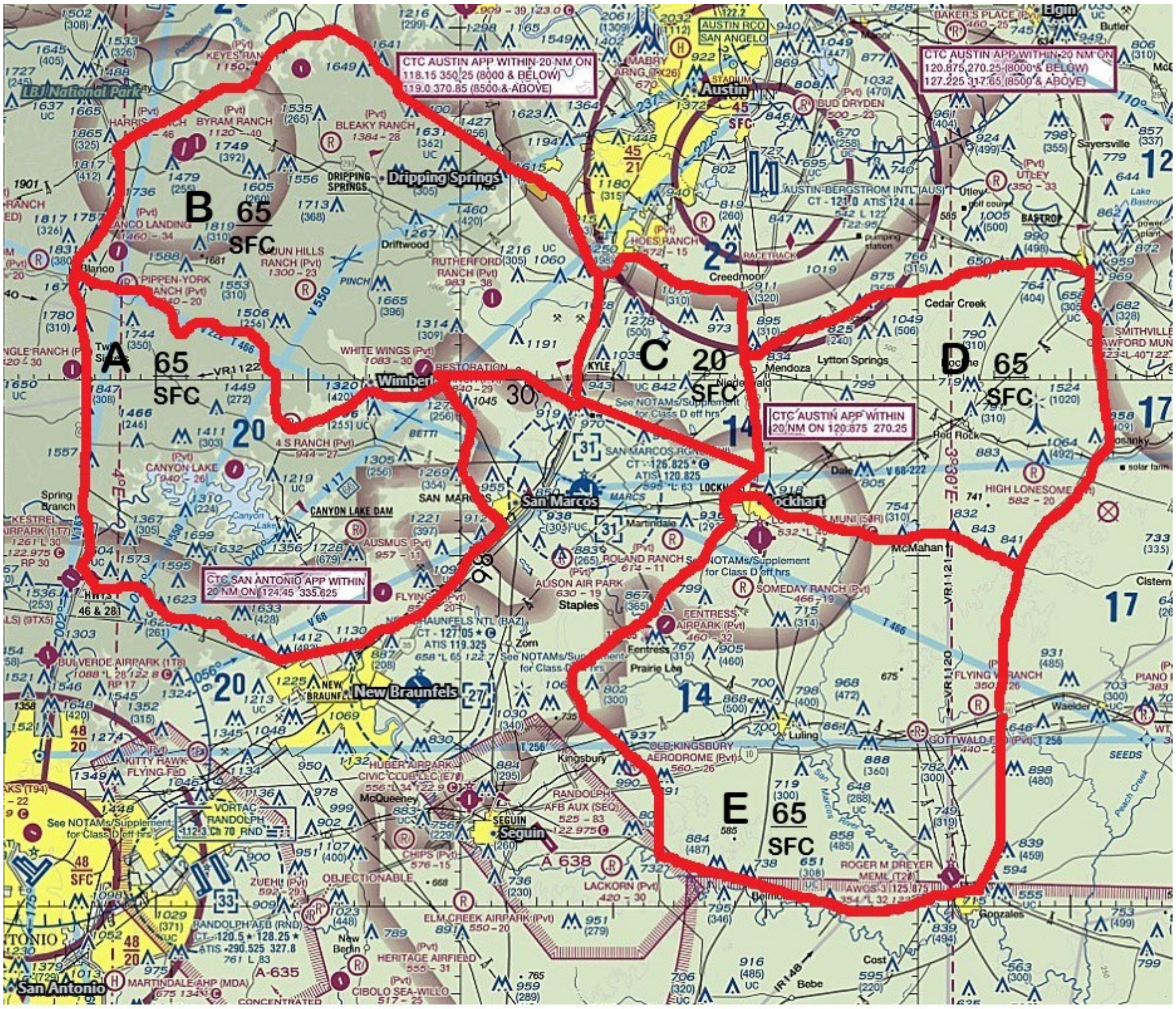
	W edge of City of Griffin				
D	GA-16 between Griffin and Jackson	US-41 between Griffin and Barnesville	Powerlines from Barnesville to Forsyth	Straight line between Jackson and Forsyth	Up to 6,000 MSL
E	US 19/41 south of Atlanta Speedway to warehouse complex south of McDonough to Tussahaw Reservoir	US 19/41 from Hampton to Griffin	GA-16 from Griffin to Jackson	Straight line from Tussahaw Reservoir to Jackson	Up to 5,000 MSL
X (spin area)	Straight line between intersection of I-85 and I-185 and Town of Greenville	Intersection of I-85 and I-185 south to intersection with US-27 then following US-27 to Town of Pine Mountain	Railroad tracks from Town of Pine Mountain to Roosevelt (5A9)	US-29 from Greenville to Roosevelt (5A9)	No additional restriction

FFC Practice Area Frequency – 122.750
US Aviation Academy FFC practice area frequency will be used when operating in all of the above

Falcon Field Practice Areas and Reporting Points



SAN MARCOS REGIONAL (KHYI)

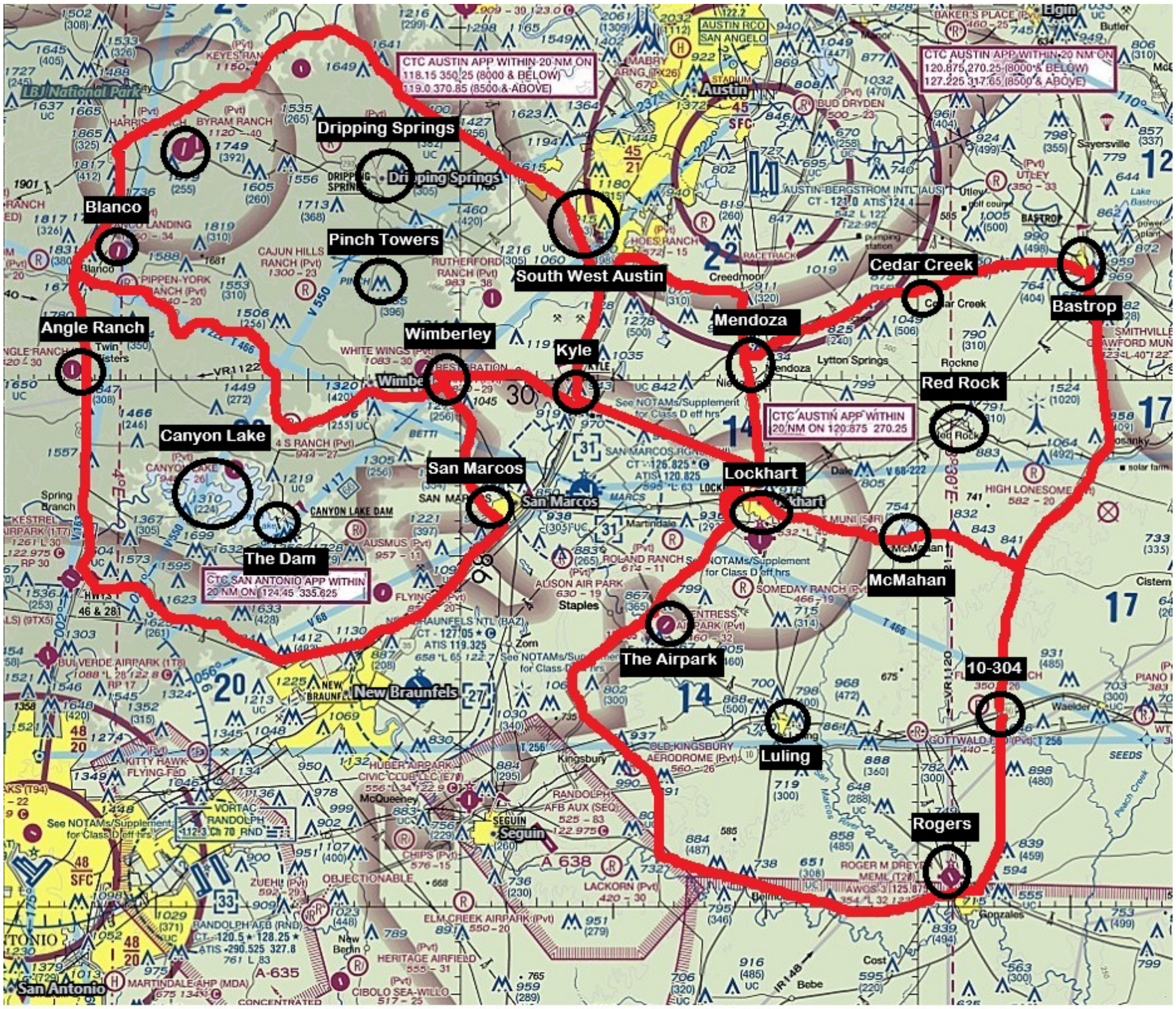


Area	Northern Boundary	Eastern Boundary	Southern Boundary	Western Boundary	Altitude
A	Blanco river	FM1102/ Loop 337	SH 46	US 281	SFC-6500
B	SH 71	FM 1626	Blanco River	US 281	SFC-6500
C	SH 45	SH130	NE of the line formed by Lockhart, Kyle and Uhland	FM 2770	SFC-2000
D	SH 21	SH 304	FM 713	SH 183	SFC-6500
E	FM 713	SH 304	US 90A	SH 130	SFC-6500

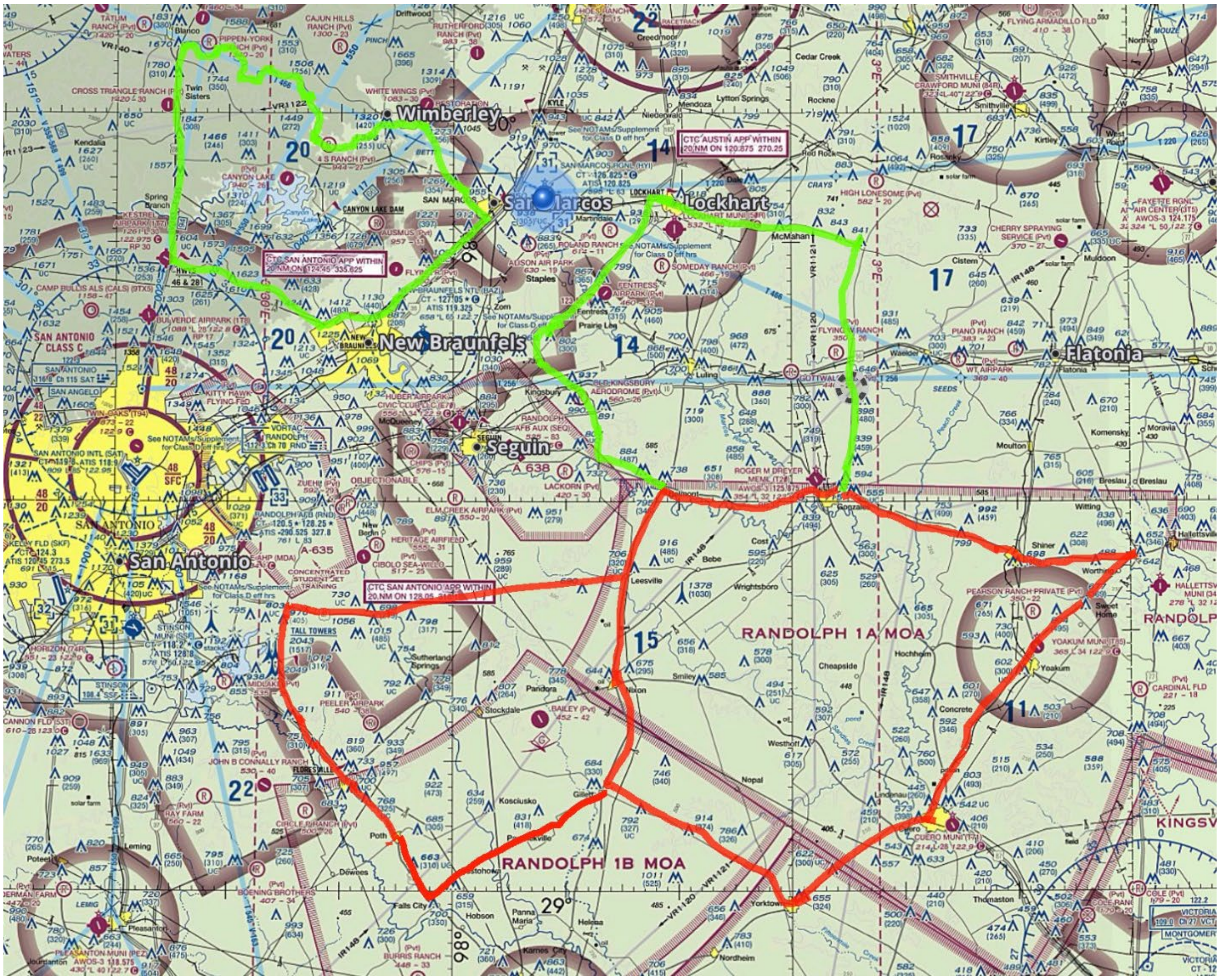
HYI Practice Area Frequency – 122.750

Aviation Academy

San Marcos Practice Areas and Reporting Points



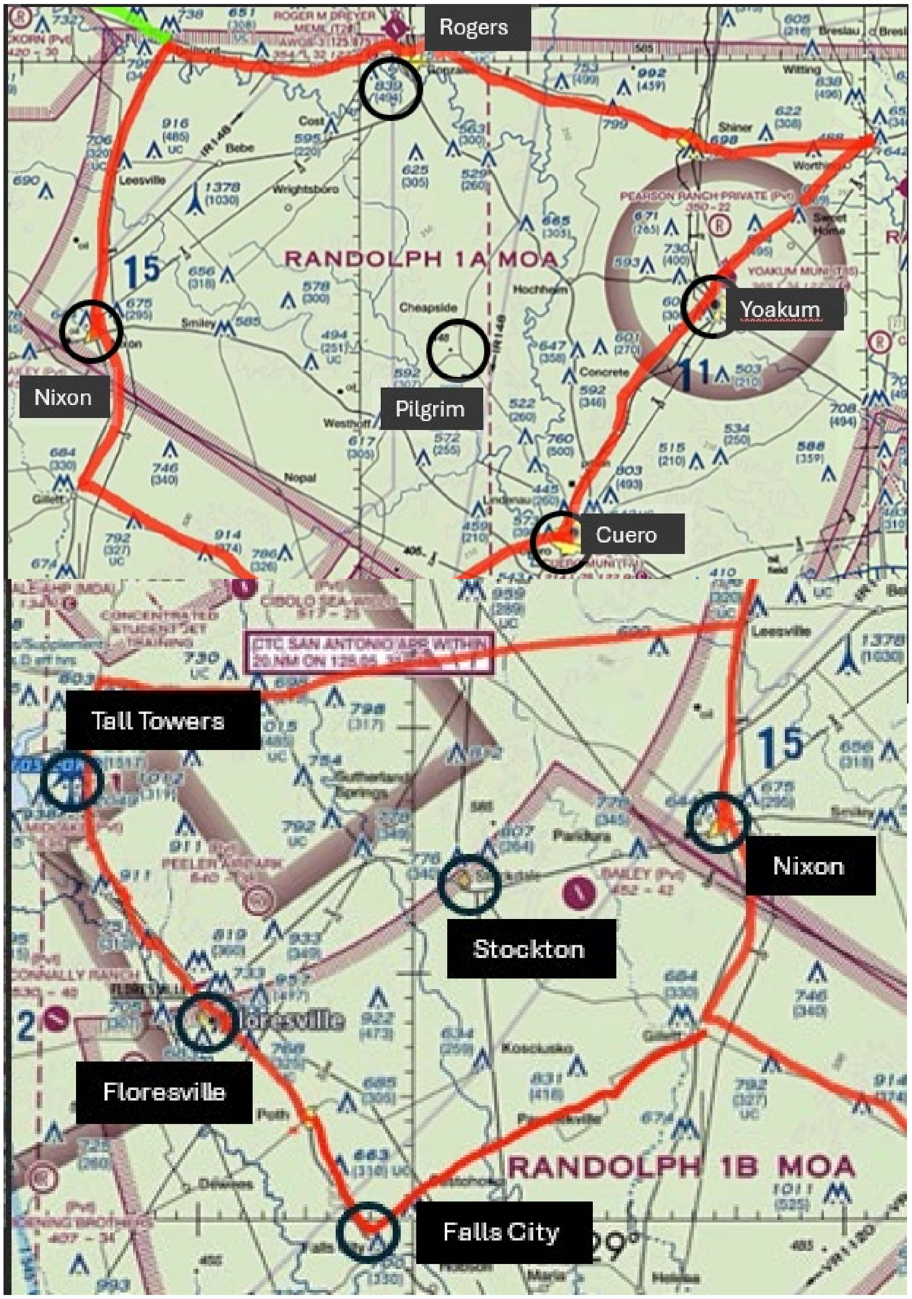
New Braunfels (KBAZ)



Area	Northern Boundary	Eastern Boundary	Southern Boundary	Western Boundary	Altitude
A	Blanco river	FM1102/ Loop 337	SH46	US 281	SFC-6500
E	FM713	SH304	US90A	SH130	SFC-6500
F	US90A	SH72/ US77	SH119	SH80	SFC-5500
G	US87/Leesville	SH80	SH887	Loop 1604/ US87	SFC-3500
Area	**Northern Boundary**	**Eastern Boundary**	**Southern Boundary**	**Western Boundary**	**Altitude**

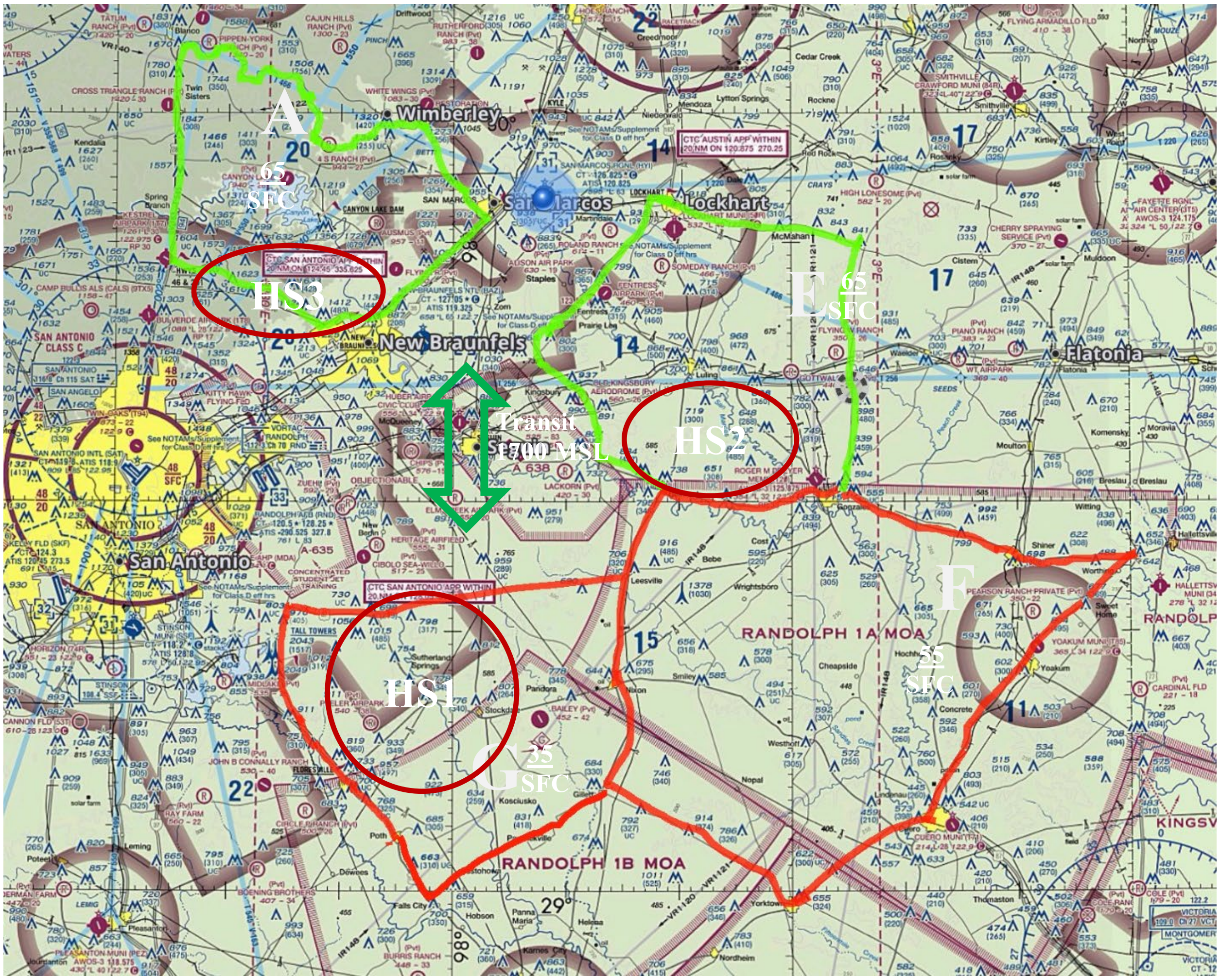
BAZ Practice Area Frequency – 122.75

New Braunfels (KBAZ) Reporting Points



NOTE: A and E airspace shared with San Marcos, see section 8.2 for reporting points.

New Braunfels (KBAZ) Hot Spots



Notes:

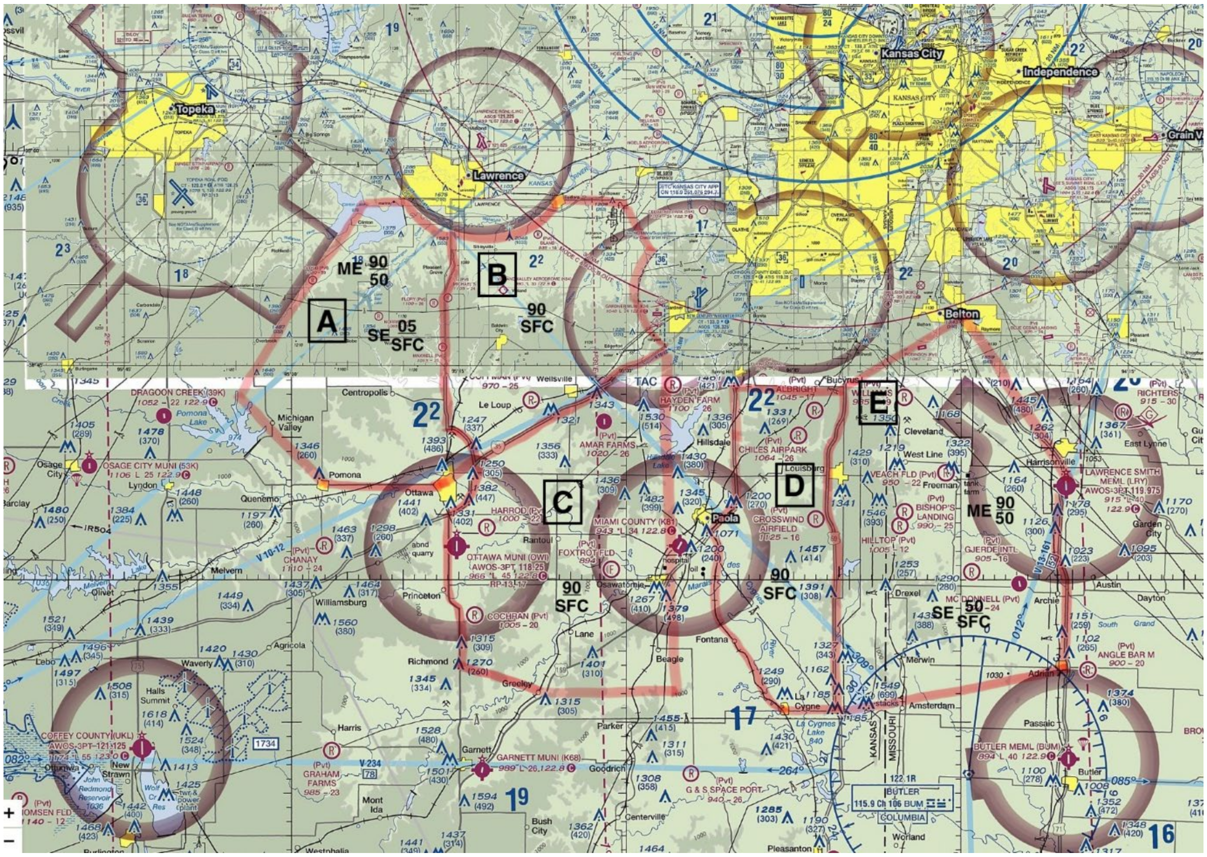
Hot Spot 1 – Extensive military traffic in this area, recommend avoid the area west of Stockdale during military training times (M-F, 0800-1730). Use flight following with San Antonio Approach when operating in this area.

Hot Spot 2 – Moderate military traffic in this area when Seguin Aux field is active (reported on KBAZ ATIS). Recommend avoiding the area South of Luling and west of the San Marcos river when Seguin is active. If operating in this area while Seguin is active, recommend flight following with San Antonio Approach. Transiting this area at or below 1500' MSL ensures separation from military traffic.

Hot Spot 3 – Potential conflict with aircraft conducting the Hi ILS Approach into Randolph Air Force Base. Recommend flight following with San Antonio Approach if operating in this area.

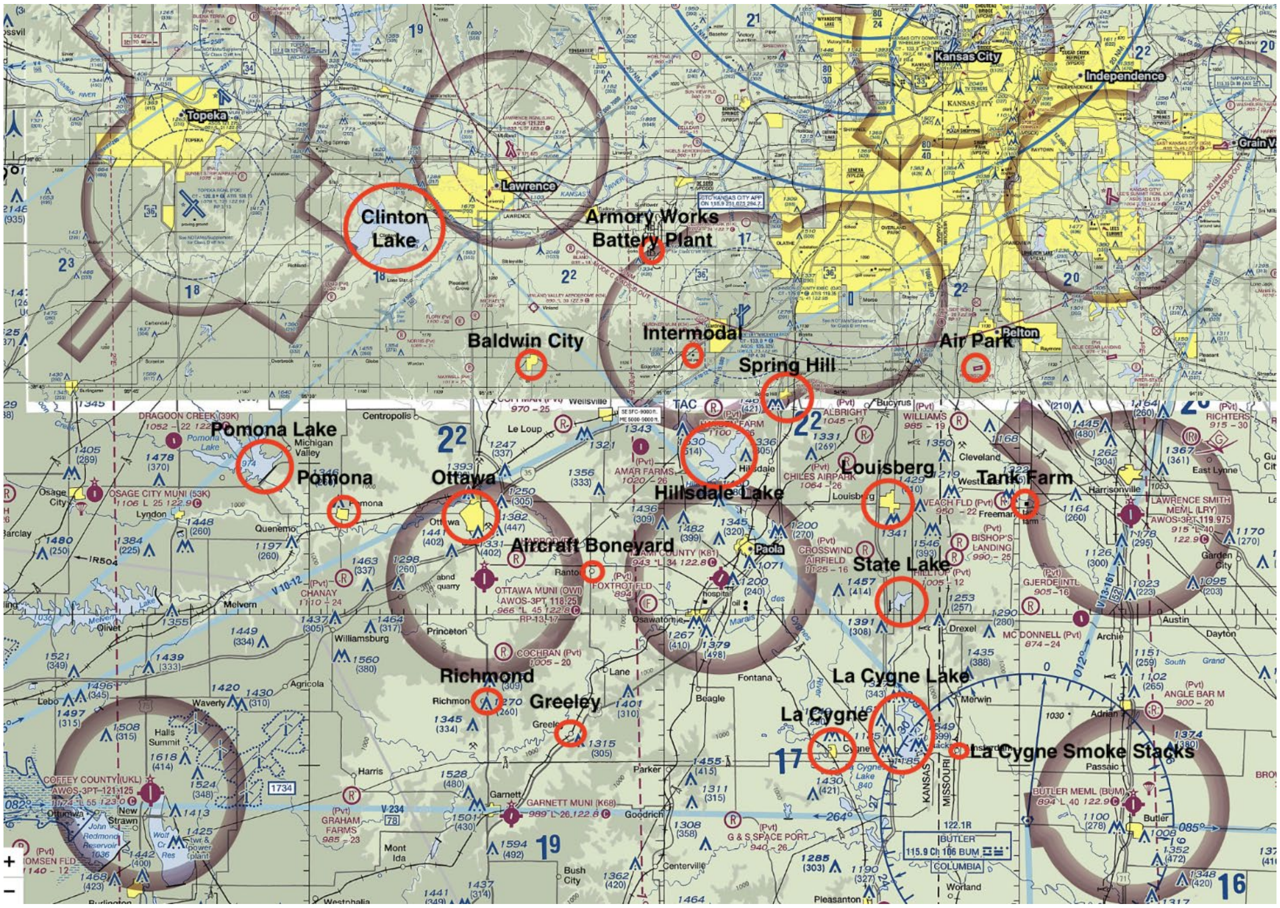
Transition from KBAZ to the south – when Seguin Aux Field is active, transition at 1700' MSL and announce intentions to "Seguin Traffic" on 122.975. Example – Seguin Traffic, Skyhawk 12345 transiting from New Braunfels to Golf working area at 1700 feet

NEW CENTURY AIRCENTER (KIXD)



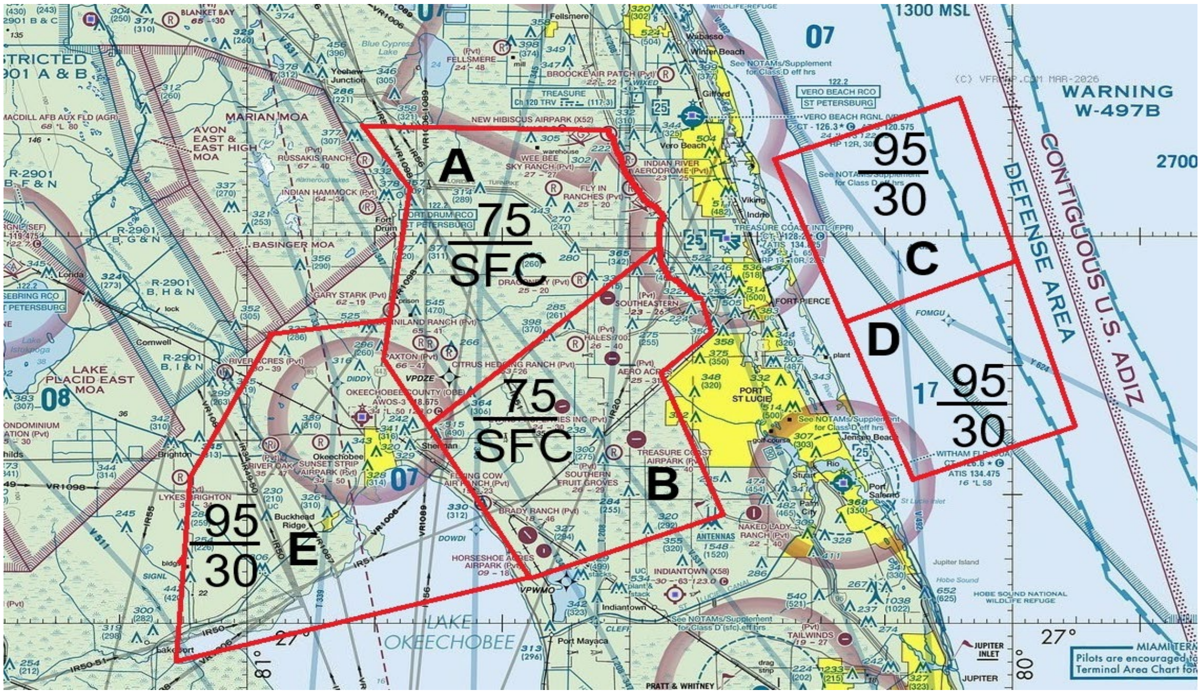
Area	Northern Boundary	Eastern Boundary	Southern Boundary	Western Boundary	Altitudes
A	Clinton Lake	Highway 59	Pomona Lake / Town of Ottawa	Pomona Lake	SE SFC-9000 ft. ME 5000-9000 ft.
B	Towns Lawrence /Town of Eudora / Armory Works	Armory Works / Intermodal	I-35	Highway 59	SFC-9000 ft.
C	I-35	Intermodal / Town of Oswatomie	Town of Richmond / Town of Greeley	i-35 / Town of Ottawa	SFC-9000 ft.
D	Town of Spring Hill / 10 Miles North Town of Louisberg	10 M North Town of Louisberg / La Cygne Lake	Town of LaCygne	Town of Spring Hill / 5 Miles West Town of La Cygne	SFC-9000 ft.
E	10 Miles North Town of Louisberg /Town of Belton	Town of Harrisonville	La Cygne Lake / Town of Adrian	Highway 69	SE SFC-9000 ft. ME 5000-9000 ft.

NEW CENTURY AIRCENTER (KIXD) REPORTING POINTS



IXD Practice Area Frequency – 122.750

TREASURE COAST INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT (KFPR)



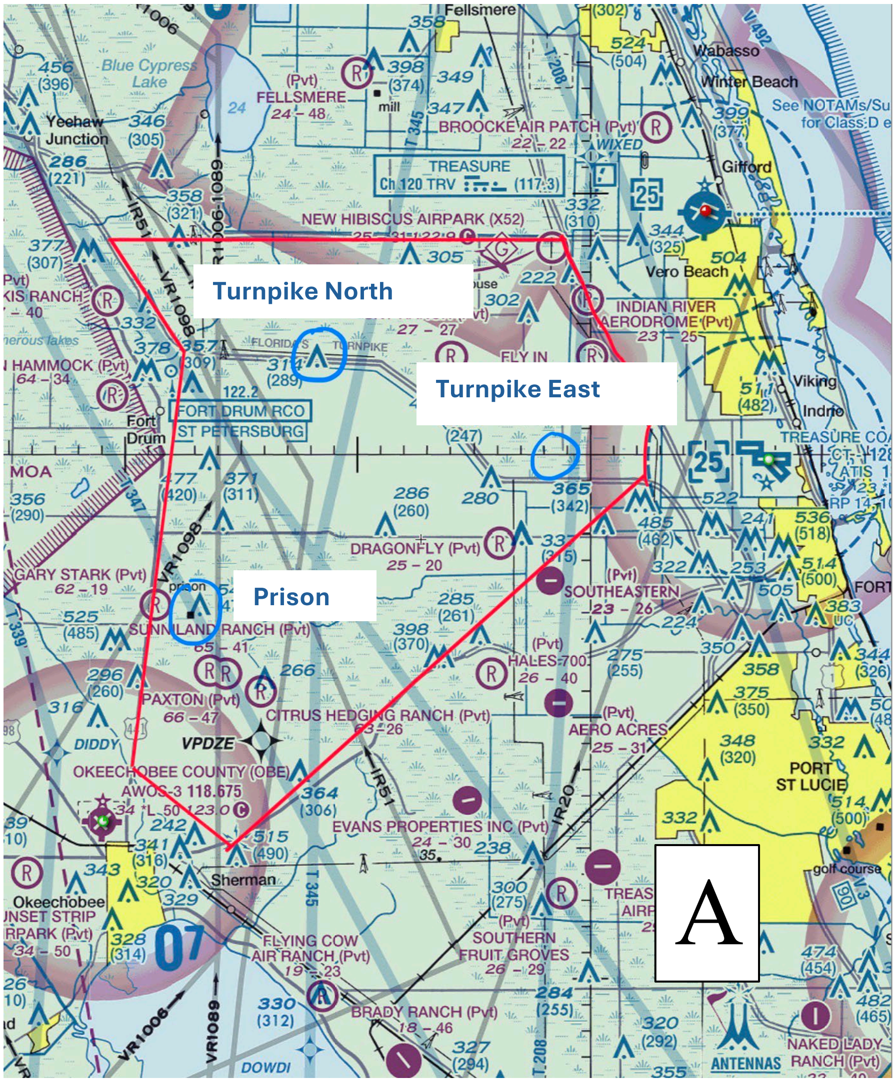
Fort Pierce (KFPR) Practice Areas

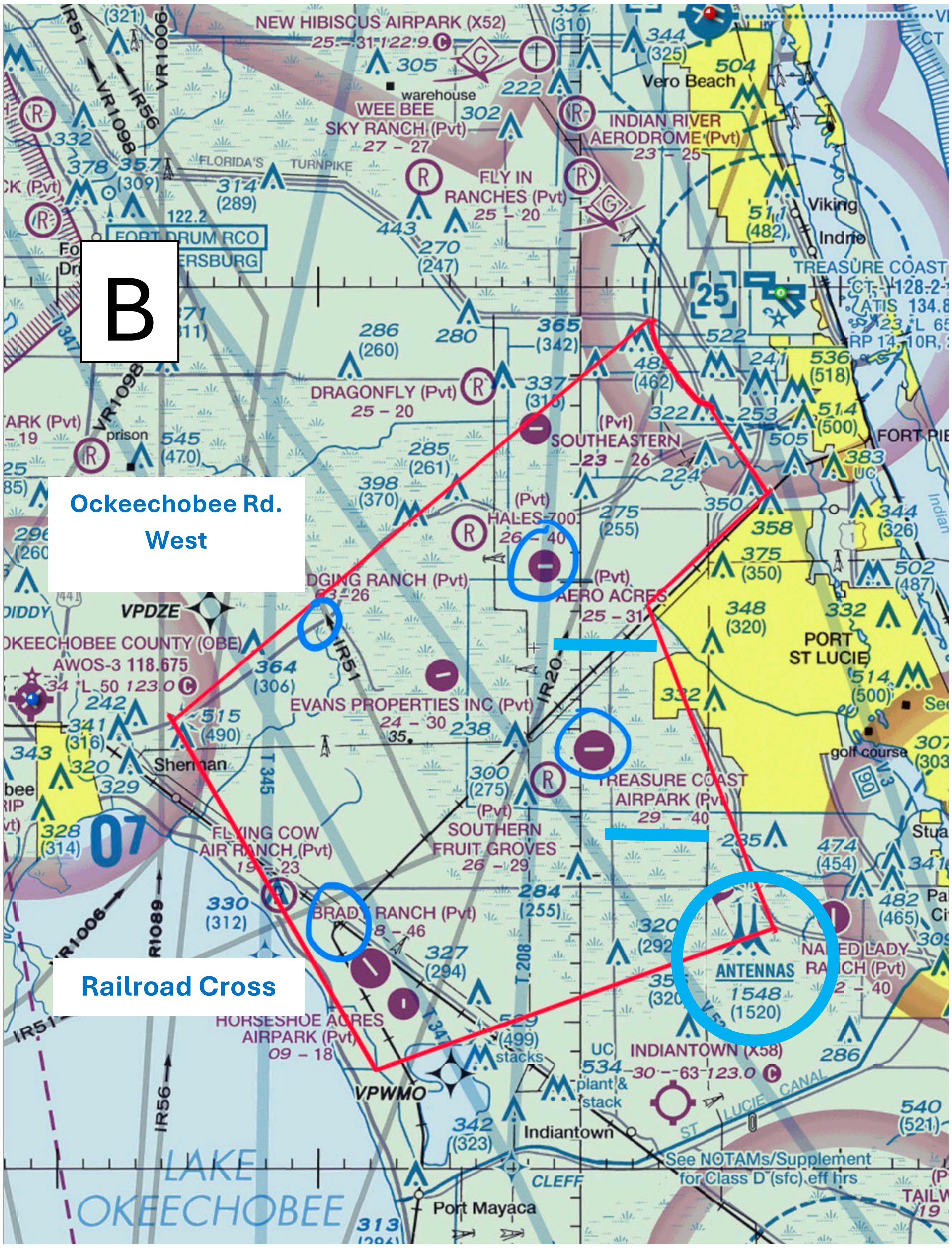
Area	Northern Boundary	Eastern Boundary	Southern Boundary	Western Boundary	Altitude
A	SR60	I-95 and KFPR class D	East Turnpike bend – Southeastern (FD30) - Mosquito Creek	Mosquito Creek – North OckeeChobee - SR441 – Turnpike to Padgetts Cemetary	SFC-7500
B	East Turnpike bend – Southeastern (FD30) - Mosquito Creek	KFPR class D – I95 to Antennas	Antennas – Port Maya Polo Club	Port Maya Polo Club – Flying Cow Air Ranch – Mosquito Creek	SFC-7500
C	Abeam 17th Street Bridge	15NM from shoreline	Abeam power plant	2NM from shoreline	3000-9500
D	Abeam power plant	15NM from shoreline	Abeam Stuart Inlet	2NM from shoreline	3000-9500
E	SR98 x Basinger MOA – Gary Stark (5FL6)	Gary Stark (5FL6) - SR441- North OckeeChobee – Mosquito Creek – Flying Cow Air Ranch - Port Maya Polo Club	Port Maya Polo Club - Lakeport	Lakeport – Lykes Brightin (8FD5) - SR98 x Basinger MOA	3000-9500

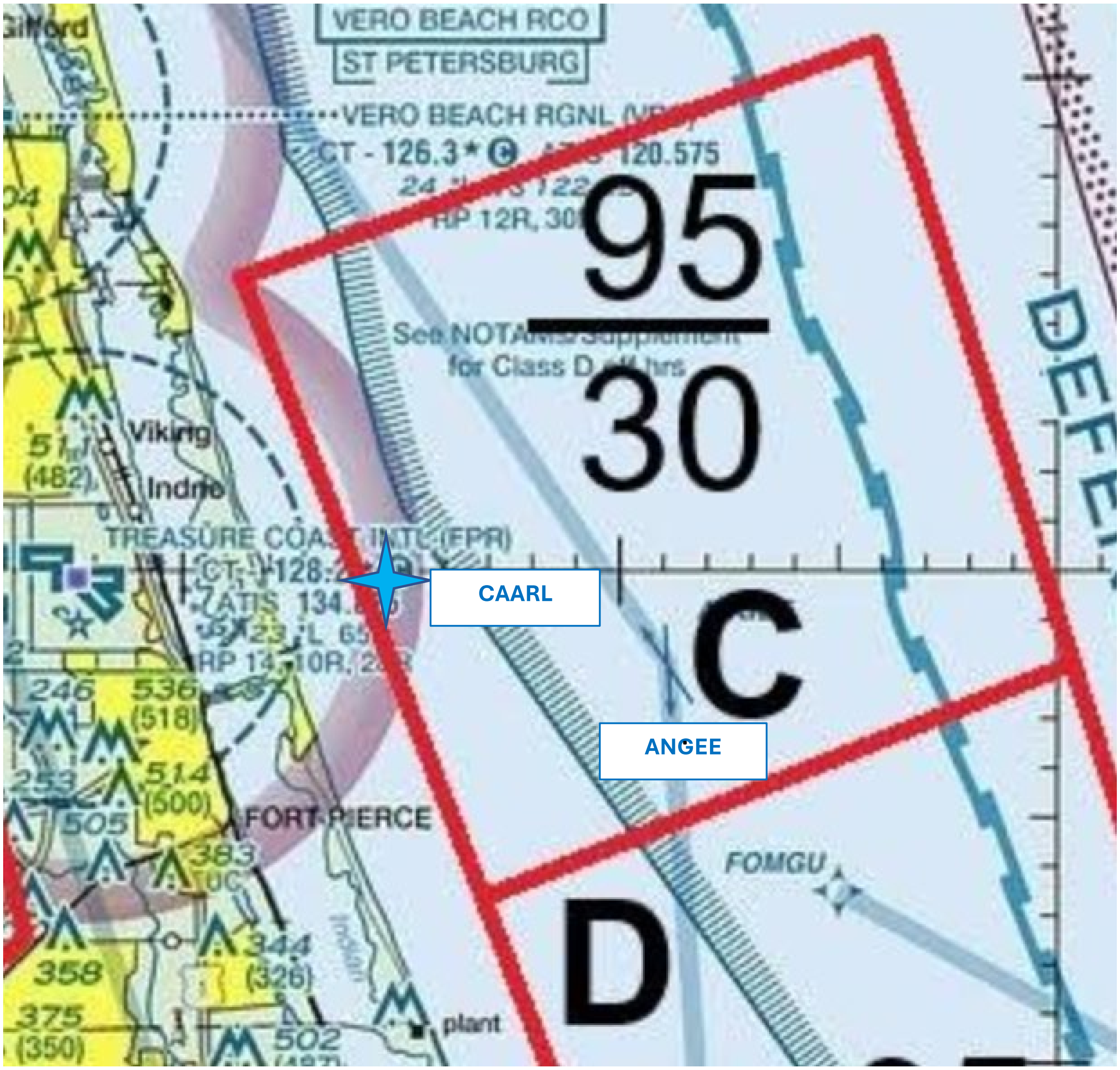
FPR Practice Area Frequency – 122.750

US Aviation Academy FPR practice area frequency will be used when operating in all the above.

TREASURE COAST INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT (KFPR) REPORTING POINTS




B
Ockeechobee Rd.
West
Railroad Cross
NEW HIBISCUS AIRPARK (X52)
Vero Beach
WEE BEE SKY RANCH (Pvt)
INDIAN RIVER AERODROME (Pvt)
FLY IN RANCHES (Pvt)
FORT DRUM RCO
TREASURE COAST
DRAGONFLY (Pvt)
SOUTHEASTERN
HALES 700
AERO ACRES
FORT PIE
PORT ST LUCIE
VPDZE
OKEECHOBEE COUNTY (OBE)
AWOS-3 118.675
EVANS PROPERTIES INC (Pvt)
Sherman
TREASURE COAST AIRPARK (Pvt)
FLYING COW AIR RANCH (Pvt)
SOUTHERN FRUIT GROVES
BRADY RANCH (Pvt)
ANTENNAS
1548
(1520)
NAKED LADY RANCH (Pvt)
HORSESHOE ACRES AIRPARK (Pvt)
VPWMO
INDIANTOWN (X58)
Indiantown
See NOTAMs/Supplement for Class D (sfc) eff hrs
LAKE OKEECHOBEE
Port Mayaca
CLEFF
ST LUCIE CANAL
golf course


VERO BEACH RCO
ST PETERSBURG
VERO BEACH RGNL
CT - 126.3
95
30
See NOTAMs/Supplement for Class D eff hrs
TREASURE COAST INTL (FPR)
CAARL
C
ANGEE
FORT PIERCE
FOMGU
D
plant
Viking
Indrio
Gifford


FOMGU
CPTAN
C
D
FORT PIERCE
plant
502
(487)
344
(326)
514
(500)
307
(303)
25
Rio
Stuart
Port Salerno
Palm City
482
(465)
368
(350)
Y 624
V492
ATIS 134.475
SE AREA
95
30

FPR Practice Area Frequency – 122.750

DEFINITIONS & ABBREVIATIONS

DEFINITIONS

Elevated Squawk: A squawk is considered “elevated” when it occurs for second time within a 50-hour aircraft total time period. Elevated squawks may only be cleared by the Director of Maintenance, Repair Station Managers, or the Chief Inspector.

Sterile Cockpit: Means no casual radio communications or unnecessary conversation in the cockpit shall take place during this time.

Squawk: 1. *noun*. A general term used synonymously for an aircraft discrepancy. 2. *verb*. The action of submitting and recording a aircraft discrepancy.

Flight Schedule Pro: USAA’s official student management system.

On Airport Landing: Landing at a public airport with a hard surface runway.

Off Airport Landing: Landing at any place other than a public airport with a hard surface runway.

Official Weather: Weather obtained through FAA authorized Aviation Weather sources.

Unprogrammed Landing: Landing that was not in the original planned flight.

ABBREVIATIONS

FSP	Flight Schedule Pro
AFM	Airplane Flight Manual
POH	Pilots Operating Handbook
IM/OM	Information Manual / Owner’s Manual
ILS	Instrument Landing System
FAF	Final Approach Fix
AGL	Above Ground Level
MSL	Mean Sea Level
SOP	Standard Operating Procedures
FOM	Flight Operations Manual
SPP	Safety Procedures and Practices
FAT	Flight Analysis Tool (Form)
BAI	Basic Attitude Instrument
TPA	Traffic Pattern Altitude